

The SILICA GEL

PSEUDOMORPH
AND
OTHER STORIES

—e—
HART

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SILICA GEL

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AND
OTHER STORIES

©
HART

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE SILICA
GEL PSEUDOMORPH, AND OTHER STORIES ***

The Silica Gel Pseudomorph

And Other Stories

BY

EDWARD HART,

Author of "Our Farm in Cedar Valley."

EASTON, PA.
THE CHEMICAL PUBLISHING CO.
1924

LONDON, ENGLAND:
WILLIAMS & NORGATE
14 HENRIETTA STREET, COVENT GARDEN, W. C.

TOKYO, JAPAN:
MARUZEN COMPANY, LTD.
11-18 NIHONBASHI TORI-SANCHOME.

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To Harvey Washington Wiley,

Scholar, Teacher, Poet, Writer and Speaker,
Fearless Publicist, Lifelong Friend.

I have a boy who loves to have me tell him stories. True stories usually need modification and adornment if they are to remain interesting, and so many stories told him were embellished. These stories have been written for my own amusement at night while others were sleeping or as a rest between more serious tasks. Some of these are true, some partly true and some are products of the imagination.

Edward Hart.

October 1, 1924

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The Silica Gel Pseudomorph

South Jersey is a very sandy country. There are miles and miles of sand there. Some of it is very pure white sand used for making glass and for molding sand. Some of this sand has sharp edges but most of it is rounded as if the grains had rolled around until the edges were worn away. Mr. Kummel has written a paper about this sand in the Report of the New Jersey State Geological Survey for 1906. His paper is entitled "The Glass Sand Industry of New Jersey." It is a very interesting paper though you might not think so from the title.

There are also very large beds of green and red sand. The green sand is especially interesting because it contains such immense amounts of alumina, iron and potash. If our chemists can only find cheap methods for extracting these substances we shall have enough to last us forever.

The most curious thing about this green sand is that it is still forming in the water along our coasts. Here the limestone shells of dead foraminifera are slowly filling up with the green substance as their bodies decay. The shells are slowly dissolved by the sea water at the same time, so that the green sand grains give a perfect cast of the inside of the shells.

I became interested in this sand while I was in college. The professor sent me down to Mullica Hill to get a load of it to experiment with. He wanted to find a way to work it. At Mullica Hill I heard that a farmer by the name of Peter Norman had a pit on his farm. One of the loafers there offered to go along and show me the way. I told him he might go if he would get the

farmer to let me have a load of sand for nothing and help me load. This he promised to do. On the way he informed me that Norman's daughter, Euphemia, had taken a notion to him and that probably they would jine up. I said I was looking for a wife myself and if I liked her looks I would take her along, but I must be sure first that she was a good cook. He looked me over as if I were some kind of an insect and asked me how much I weighed. I told him all of fifty tons.

When we got to the house Euphemia came to the door herself. I must say she was a fine looking girl with very mischievous eyes. She said her father was down at the other end of the farm and my friend had better go and get him. Then she giggled. When he had gone she looked at me and giggled some more. Said I might go ahead and take all the sand I wanted. I asked her if she was sure her father would be willing and she said: Sure! She said she would show me the pit and got on the seat beside me. As we drove along she told me that one of her girl friends had told Sim she was gone on him.

I said, "yes, so he told me."

"Did he?" says she, "the poor simp!"

"If you go about breaking hearts like that," said I, "you'll get in jail next. I understand that the sheriff has been instructed to jug all the flappers." This made her giggle some more.

She stood by the side of the pit while I threw the sand into the truck. After I had been digging a bit my shovel struck something that felt like rubber. It was round like a rubber ball as I uncovered it and larger than a canteloupe. I tried to throw it out, but it seemed to be fastened to something at one side. I went on digging and was getting interested when I heard some one shouting, and there was the farmer coming as fast as he could, waving his arms and shouting with all the breath he had left. When he reached the pit he was puffing and blowing so he could hardly speak, but he made it plain that he was cross because I had dug without permission, said I had no business to do it, it was trespass, and he had a great mind to have me arrested.

I said that his daughter had allowed me to dig but this did not seem to satisfy him. Euphemia told him I wasn't hurting anything and he needn't

make a goose of himself, so he quieted down. Asked what the round ball was? I told him I didn't know and he got a shovel and dug too. After awhile the girl said:

"Why it looks like a man!"

It did, too. We went on digging and uncovered his legs and then his feet. They *were* feet all right, but he was the queerest looking thing you ever saw. After he was uncovered we turned him over and I declare he had a nose, mouth and ears; it was a man! But the oddest looking man you ever saw. His body was nearly transparent; like cloudy glass. You could see all his bones through this. He looked like stiff jelly with pieces of cotton in it. We looked at him and then at one another.

"Well, I vum," said Papa.

"Did you ever," said Phemy.

"Geewhitakers," said Sim.

The farmer brought out a wide board and we rolled him on it. Then I nailed narrow boards on the side, so that he was in a kind of a trough. There he lay, glistening in the sunlight. When I looked up I saw that Euphemia was giggling again.

"Why the laugh?" said I.

"Don't you think he looks funny? I never expected to see a man's bones like that."

It hadn't struck me that way before but it was funny, and I had to laugh too. Just then the man sneezed. Euphemia gathered up her skirts, for she had on a long dress, not one of the bathing suits the flappers wear on the streets nowadays, and made a bee line for the house. I felt kind of scary myself. It isn't every day, I can tell you, that you dig up a jelly corpse and have him sneeze just as life-like! Pop Norman by this time was as white as a sheet. But what the corpse did next certainly made me stare. He opened one eye, and after looking around a bit, confused-like, he looked at me, and *winked*. I certainly was flabbergasted. Then he opened the other eye and sat up. Then the farmer scooted. The corpse began to talk to himself in some kind of outlandish jabber. I thought it sounded like Spanish but it came out like lightning and I couldn't get it. I had studied Spanish at college but I was not

very well acquainted with it. After saying the same thing over three or four times he turned to me and said it again—slowly, and quite imperiously. He was asking where his clothes were. I said I didn't know but would enquire. I went to the house and found Euphemia very badly scared and the old man drinking blackberry brandy. He called it a cordial. I insisted that he get some clothes for the stranger and we picked out an old suit I thought might fit. I took these out to the Spaniard but he was much displeased with them and said he was not accustomed to such garb. I told him it was that or nothing and the girl was coming so finally he put them on. He seemed to be about as spry as ordinary people, and his manner was very polite.

Euphemia got over her fright after awhile and came downstairs but she seemed quite shook up. After awhile the Spaniard tried to talk to her but of course she couldn't understand until I translated for her. After awhile she seemed to like to hear what he said. His talk was quite high-flown, and after every few words he would put his hand on his chest and make a low bow. This seemed to suit Euphemia.

It was getting on towards evening and I was obliged to leave but I asked Euphemia to take care of him and I promised to bring a Spanish book so she could make out what he said, and I told him to stay here until I got back. He promised to do so and I went away.

When I told the professor about my glass man he smiled and smiled. He said the Spaniard must be a silica gel pseudomorph, and he was surprised and delighted he or it could talk Spanish, and when he said this he grinned like a Cheshire cat. I got a Spanish dictionary and phrase book at the college bookstore and went back next day. I found he was trying to explain the difference between *ser* and *estar*. It struck me that was a funny thing to do, but he seemed rather touchy, so I gave her the books and went back to college. I was very busy the rest of the term and couldn't get away, but as soon as possible I went back. They were out riding the old man said, and he seemed rather put out.

When they came back I tried to tell her about the green sand, but she didn't seem to be interested and he yawned; so, after talking to the old man for awhile I came away. She didn't ask me to come again. He was polite but quite formal.

I saw no more of the Normans nor of my Spanish friend for a month. I was in Trenton one afternoon and was walking on the street when who should I run into but the Normans. They were staying with an aunt of hers and I went with them. We sat up pretty late that night while Euphemia told me about the Spaniard. She said she wondered I hadn't heard about it; part of it, it seemed, had got into the newspapers.

She told me she soon got so she could talk Spanish pretty well. It was not difficult except that miserable *ser* and *estar*. They both meant the same thing and you were pretty sure to use the wrong one. I told her it was like the old lady who knew the difference between soldier and shoulder but never could tell which was which. She said the Spaniard talked all the time. He was so polite that at first she liked him pretty well, but he never seemed to like her father and didn't treat him very well. He claimed to be a *hidalgo*, which appeared to be some kind of a nobleman. He was terribly stuck on himself. He was a ferocious eater and kept her cooking most of the time. He was always asking for *dos huevos fritos* or *carne de vaca*. "He kept me fryin eggs or Dad runnin to town for meat all the time. I believe he could eat a gallon of soup, and it took so much butter to fry the *papa fritos* that we had none left for anything else. He was fond of fish, too, and was always askin for them. This got so bad that Dad and I concluded we had better take him down to the shore where fish don't cost so much. By this time something got the matter with him. It had been rather cool and moist up to this time but by the time we were ready to start there was a hot dry spell. Before this you could see everything inside his head except where the bones were in the way. But now white patches like snow began to grow on his face, and pretty soon he began to look like a snow man. His face was perfectly white without a trace of color. It was frightful. I kinda liked his looks before that. You needn't laugh; you like the good lookin women best, and I don't see any reason why we shouldn't like the good lookin men."

"If he didn't get what he wanted at once he flew into an awful rage, and it was pretty fierce, I can tell you, to have Snow White rampagin around. So we took him to the shore, or at least we started for the shore. He had a sword that the blacksmith had made for him out of an old scythe of Dad's and belt around him to hold it. I said we might be arrested for carrying such things around, but Dad said you could not carry concealed weapons, but nothing was said about other kinds, and there was nothing concealed about

that sword. So we started off in the wagon, and he sat in the front seat with Dad. Pretty soon I noticed that little white scales was driftin down from him on the floor. It was hot that day but he didn't seem to feel it in any other way, but all the time those little white scales kept siftin down 'till the floor was all white. I didn't like to say anything for fear of hurtin his feelings but I got mighty nervous.

"We had been on the way about an hour when he spied some oranges in a store we was passin, and he got out, went in and took them. Didn't stop to pay, just took them and came out. The store keeper came out and said, politely, that he had forgotten to pay, but Snow White flew into a rage and began to swear frightful. He pulled out his sword and chased the store keeper into his store. Then we drove on, but by this time Dad and I were scared stiff. About an hour later we passed through Swedesboro when a little fellow with a star on his coat came up and told us we were his prisoners. The Spaniard jumped out and ran at him with the sword. The constable was plucky; he pulled out a pistol and fired at the Spaniard, but he didn't hit him, and the Spaniard chased him a ways down the road. We drove on then but more scared than before. I asked the Spaniard if he wasn't afraid of being put in jail but he said no, they wouldn't dare touch a hidalgo.

"Pretty soon we came to a cross road and somebody yelled at us from a clump of bushes 'Surrender in the name of the law.' But that didn't frighten him. He just jumped out and charged that clump and drove the two men in it down the road. By this time we were almost to Pennsgrove. I was so scared that I got off and ran down a side street and Dad after me. We didn't see any more of him but we was told he drove in as large as life and met the Sheriff, with two deputies. He chased them and cut one of them pretty bad. Then he ran to the wharf, jumped on a fishing boat, cut the cable and started down the river. The revenue cutter got after him and they fired a shot at the boat. This made her fill and she went down but they managed to pull him out. Of course he got very wet. They took him to the jail, gave him some dry clothes and put him in a cell. They captured Dad and me too, but after they had asked us a lot of questions they concluded we wasn't to blame and let us go. I went to see the Spaniard next day and, say, he was a sight! All the white scales was gone but they had been thicker in some places than in others, and where they had been thickest there was a kind of a pit on his face like a man who had small pox. He looked fierce, but the water had

made him look like glass again. There was no snow white stuff on him at all.

“They took him before a J. P. that day and he told them he was a Spanish nobleman who was willing to die for Spain. He said he had sunk many English ships and killed many English and that he was going to do it some more.”

“Now, I don’t know what you think,” Euphemia said to me, “but I think that fellow had been thrown overboard from some ship and was petrified on the bottom of the sea and covered with sand. When you dug him up he just came to life again. He must have been a bird when he was alive, and so he just went on being a bird when he came back to life.”

“Well, the Justice of the Peace thought he must be crazy so he sent him to the asylum. But he didn’t stay there long. He broke loose one night, made for the shore, killed two men who was sleepin in a small vessel, pulled up the anchor and put to sea and hasn’t been heard of since.”

Peep-Chick Mountain

Over in that funny state called New Jersey there is a mountain called Peep-Chick Mountain, or something like that, and this is the story of how it got the name:

There was once a band of robbers who lived in a cave on the side of this big mountain. They stole sheep and pigs and chickens from the farmers who lived in the valley. Once they had no bread, and the chief robber said: "Go and steal all the eggs you can find and we will trade them for bread at the store." So they all went out to steal eggs except one. He was a red-headed robber and he said: "I think I am for Direct Action. I don't believe in this roundabout business of stealing eggs and then trading them for bread. Besides I should like to have some pie and cake also." So he went down to the road and hid in some bushes.

Pretty soon a big automobile came whishing by. "Go along whisher!" said the robber, "I can't eat you." Then a truck came rumbling by. "Get along, rumble bumble," said Red Head. Then along came a baker's cart. "Hi!" said Reddy, "Here's the Staff of Life!" So saying, he pulled out his pistol and fired at the tire. There was a bang and rattle, just as if a pane of glass had fallen on the sidewalk, and the baker's cart began to wobble and pound on the road. "Ho!" said the baker's boy who was driving, "there goes a tire." He got down and went around the car. Just then Reddy came rushing up.

"Hands up for pie!" said he.

The baker's boy was so frightened that he ran and jumped into the canal, swam across and hid behind some trees. The robber fired several shots after him but they only splashed the water and scared the boy. Then Reddy unfastened a bag which had been wrapped around him and shoved in pies, cakes, loaves of bread and doughnuts as fast as he could. When this was full he filled another bag. Then he tied the two together, flung them over his back and made off as fast as he could.

Presently the watchman spied Red Head coming up the hill with his bags of pies, bread, cake and doughnuts. It was misty and he loomed through the fog like a donkey carrying sacks.

"Hey, Jack!" called the watch, "Ohe, Ohe!"

"Ohe yourself!" said Red Head fetching him a slap over the head. But he struck hard and lost his balance, fell and rolled down the hill. The other robbers rushed out and grabbed him, but soon discovered that it was Red Head and let him go.

"I know what your eggs will look like," said the chief.

When they turned the bags inside out they found the pies, cake, doughnuts and bread all mashed together. There was blackberry pie making a red streak and lemon custard making a yellow streak, with doughnuts flattened out and loaves of bread between. The juice of the pies had been soaked up by the bread and cake.

"Hey!" said the chief, "What have we here?"

"That," said Reddy, "is pie-cake-doughnut-bread."

"It looks it," said the chief, "but I believe we can eat it."

So they sat down and ate some; and, sure enough, it was good.

In the meantime the other robbers who had gone out had stolen all the eggs they could find and put them in another cave near by. There were 503 dozen in all. Now it happened that there was a hot spring in one corner of the cave where the eggs were stored and after they had lain there long enough they began to hatch out. One morning when the robbers came out of their cave they heard a great rustling and peeping all over the hillside. There were 5798 peeps moving through the grass and among the trees and crying: "peep! peep!"

“Goodness!” said the robber chief, “look at our eggs! they are hungry.”

That night they stole a feed grinder from a farmer in the valley and several bags of corn. Three robbers shelled corn, three drove the mill, three fed the corn and three made mush of the meal and fed it to the peeps. The other robbers stole the corn and carried it up the mountain. In about two weeks they were tired out. “We are not robbers any longer,” they said, “this is work!” so they all ran away. By this time the peeps had become chicks and begun to eat grasshoppers and crickets and were able to take some care of themselves; but the foxes, weasels, skunks and minks had a fine time eating them as they scattered over the mountain side. Bye and bye the farmers caught them until there were no more left; but the mountain is called Peep-Chick, or something like that, to this day.

Round Valley

They called it Round Valley because it really was round, hemmed in by very high hills, except on the west; here there was an opening through the hills, down the middle of which flowed a mill stream which drained the valley. Part way down the gap between the hills was a mill dam; and a short distance below the dam was the mill. The miller was a little Gnome who lived in the mill with his wife and daughter. The mother had once been beautiful, but hard work had made her old before her time. Her face was wrinkled; there were crow's feet in the corners of her eyes; her steps were slow and feeble and her hair was growing gray.

The daughter was a very beautiful and charming girl; she was happy-hearted. She moved around quickly, helping her mother wash the dishes, sweep the floor, put wood on the fire, take up the ashes, milk the cow and feed the pigs and chickens. As she did these things she often smiled, and anyone who took the trouble to watch her could easily see that she had happy thoughts.

There were many Little People living in this valley. You seldom saw them but often heard them. In one place below the mill the water fell over some rocks, and here, if you listened, you could hear some of them saying: "Urgle, urgle, urgle," just as plain!

Some lived in the branches of the pines and cooed: "Whoo, whoo, whoo," and others called from the dry grass: "z-z-z." Everywhere their voices could be heard, but very soft and low—for they were Little People.

Every day the Gnome worked in the mill—pouring grain into the hopper, tying up the bags of flour and writing in a big book in one corner of the mill. His clothes were always full of flour, and though he banged them with his hands and shook himself before going into the house, he was always gray or white. He was always busy, and seldom came into the house except for meals; but he appeared to be interested in his work and quite cheerful.

One evening the sky became dark earlier than usual, and a mist fell over the valley; then the wind rose and the rain began to fall. It was a dismal night out of doors, but within the miller's house it was bright and cheerful. The window panes shone in the light from the bright fire burning in the fireplace; the curtains over the windows drooped gracefully and were clean and white; there was a bookshelf filled with new books with golden titles and a shelf filled with flowers in pots in one of the windows. The room was clean and dry and warm as the miller and his wife and daughter sat down to their evening meal.

As they sat eating and talking there came a knock at the door and the daughter went to open it. A dark-eyed Stranger was standing on the threshold. "Come in quickly," said the girl, "the wind is driving the dead leaves and the rain into the house. You are very welcome; come and share our meal!"

The Stranger muttered his thanks and drew a chair to the fire. The mother went upstairs and presently came down again. "You are very wet," said she. "I have laid out a suit of my husband's in the room above. Go up and put it on! It will keep you warm and dry until your own is ready." So saying she opened the door of the stairway and stood aside to allow the Stranger to pass.

In a short time he came down and ate a hearty meal; but his face was far from cheerful. He appeared to be gloomy and glum; he said little and looked at no one. "He is tired," said the mother to her husband, "take him up to the guest room!"

In the morning the visitor appeared to be more cheerful than before. He was still gloomy and glum, however, as he ate his breakfast. He had come down late and the miller had gone to his work in the mill. The mother was in the kitchen, and the daughter sang as she waited on him, poured water on the flowers and drew back the curtains to let more light into the room.

“Why are you sad?” said she, “see what a beautiful morning! The fleecy clouds are sailing over the hills; the mill stream is shouting for joy and the birds are singing.”

“Why should I be happy?” said he, “My wife and child are dead; I am not well and I have lost my money. Why should I rejoice?” So saying he looked gloomier and glummer than before.

“Oh, you poor man,” said the girl, “I am so sorry.” So saying she brought in another plateful of hot cakes and put a jugful of maple syrup on the table; but still she kept on singing, for her heart was filled with joy.

“It is very pleasant here,” said the Stranger. “If you do not mind I will stay a few days. I have enough money left to pay my board.”

“You must settle that with my mother,” said the girl. “It is rather lonesome here sometimes, but you will be very welcome to stay as long as you like.” So saying she ran off to tell her mother. “Oh, mother!” said she, “I think it will be splendid to have him here; he is so sad; and he has lost his wife and child and his money; and his health is poor, too. I am so sorry for him.”

“That is too bad,” said her mother, “We must be good to him and perhaps he will become more cheerful.”

At first the Stranger wandered up and down the stream, hunting in the woods or fishing in the brook. Presently he tired of this and began to help the miller. Very soon he spent most of his time in the mill. In the evening he and the daughter would sometimes take a walk through the woods or over the hills. As he worked in the mill and grew tired and hungry, and slept in the clean, sweet country air, lulled by the voices of the Little People, he grew stronger and happier; the frown left his brow; he began to smile, and presently to hum a tune.

One day the miller did not feel very well, and he went to lie down on his bed, leaving the mill in charge of the Stranger. A few days later this happened again. Presently the Gnome laid down every day, and then he became so weak that he must stay in bed all day, while the Stranger took care of the mill alone. They sent for the Doctor who said he must stay in bed until he got better. But he got no better; he grew worse each day. One day he called the Stranger to him and said: “I feel very sick, and I believe I shall soon be going to a far country; will you take care of my wife and

daughter when I am gone?" "Yes," said the Stranger, "I will do all I can. You have all been good to me and I will do my best to return your kindness."

Then the old miller turned his face to the wall and died. And they buried him beneath the whispering pines. And the daughter said: "Oh, what shall I do? What shall I do?" "Let me help you bear it," said he. Then she looked at him and smiled through her tears.

After the miller died the mother was very lonely, and she often said that she would like to go to him. Presently she, too, sickened. Every day she grew worse, and finally she died and was laid to rest beneath the spreading pines beside her man.

After the funeral they sat before the fireplace. She was crying and his eyes were wet. "What can I do?" said she, "I have no one to love me and care for me." "Yes you have," said he, "I promised your father I would take care of you, and I love you very much. It will not be hard work for me to love you and care for you."

"Oh," said she, "I am so glad you love me, I have loved you for a long time." Then she kissed him, shyly.

In a few days they were married. She cared for the house and he ran the mill. She is a good housewife and sings as she works and he is a good miller and sings as he runs the mill. They often kiss. I have noticed that when he kisses her he grows younger but as she kisses him she grows older. They grow happier every day.

Mont L'Hery

To Angelo Catto, Archbishop of Vienna, from Philip de Comines, Lord of Argenton:—

In the Memoirs which I have written, my good Lord Archbishop, at your desire, I have spoken of an occurrence of little importance, it may appear, and which was of small note among the great and mighty events which took place then and thereafter. None the less, though I have there written but a few words, (as thinking the relation of my own small affairs of little value) matters of great import to me and mine transpired which I shall here set forth, that you may, if you see fit, relate them to my dear daughter, Joan, when I am no more.

In these Memoirs I have related that after the battle of Mont l'Hery the horse I bestrode was old and tired, which thrusting by accident his head into a bucket of wine, drank it and was thereby become lustier and more serviceable than he was before. I have also there set down that on the third day after the battle we took up our quarters in the village of Mont l'Hery and that the inhabitants were in such consternation at our approach that they fled, some into the church steeple, and some into the castle, which held out against us and was not taken.

I have not set down the events of the first and second days after the battle because, as you shall see, I could not know much of them, being away on my own affairs.

After I had mounted this old, tired horse which I had ridden for several days, I laid the reins upon his neck as was my wont. Straightway he began to gallop, and when I sought to rein him in I found the bit between his teeth, and he on a mad run. We burst through the ranks of the men-at-arms, whereat I suffered not a little, being without armour at the time, and galloped hard into the village. As we turned at the church my old horse stumbled and fell and I was thrown violently into a meadow at one side of the way.

Of what happened next I know only as it was related to me thereafter. For a long time, it appeared, my wits were wandering. Then I opened my eyes to look into the eyes of a young maid bending over me anxiously. She smiled and said: "I am glad, good sir. You were as one dead. It was an ugly fall."

"Where am I?" I asked.

"You are in the house of my aunt's nurse," she replied. "She lies sick in the room above. I had come to visit her and saw you fall. I fear some of the King's men saw you also and will do you a mischief." With that there came a knocking at the door and hoarse voices shouting: "Open in the King's name!"

She opened the door and I heard loud voices talking. Three archers were there, sent, they said, to bring me to the Castle, but the maid denied them. She averred I was in great pain and unfit to be moved. There was much said that I did not fully hear (my wits not yet being fully returned), but presently she closed the door and came back.

"I have staved them off for awhile," she said, "but you must get back your wits as soon as may be, for they will come again." But I was in a maze at the beauty of her and said no word. She seemed like an angel to my sleepy eyes; for by now I felt dead tired and of a mind to sleep. This she saw and said: "Sleep, fair Sir! I will fend them from you." At which I dropped off to sleep to dream of yellow-haired angels singing; and when I awoke, of a truth she was singing in the chamber above. In a few minutes she returned quietly and, seeing I was awake, said: "I have now two patients, fair Sir, I pray you tell me how you do?"

"I am stronger," I replied "but my arm pains me, and methinks a bone may perchance be broken."

“Not so,” said she, “but it is much bruised.”

Again there was a knocking at the door, and when she opened a rough voice enquiring for me.

“He has been sleeping and is better, but he has been much bruised and must stay the night.”

“Nay, Nay!” said the archer, “that must not be. I am bidden to bring him straight to the Castle.”

“He is my patient,” she replied, “and I tell thee I will not have him moved, Count or no Count.”

“You must even have your way, Lady,” said he, “But I see a heavy reckoning to be paid if he come not soon.”

“I will answer,” said she.

When she returned: “I am beholden to you, Lady,” I said, “for your too great kindness. But I must not lead you into danger. That would be a poor return. Let me be led to the Count.”

“How say you?” she replied, “would you put your head in the noose? I tell you the Count is bitterly angry with the Count de Charolois and will hang all his men.”

“I care not,” said I, “I will not see you led into danger through my fault;” so saying, I sought to rise but fell back almost fainting.

“See,” said she, “was I not right? You are unfit to go, and I will not have you go until you are fit!” Here her eyes flashed and she stamped her little foot fiercely.

I slept but poorly that night and a fierce fever consumed me. In the morning she was much distressed and vowed again I should not be moved. Shortly there came another knock and a voice saying:

“You little vixen! What matter if he die of a fever or be hanged?”

“Hanged he may be,” she replied, “and you will, but he must come to his trial well. And you do force him to it I shall have your own head sooner or later, and that I vow!”

“I warn you the King shall hear of this!” he said.

“Let him,” she said, “and let him do his worst. I have cared for many wounded, and I have yet to ask whether they be rich or poor, or of high or low degree.”

’Tis said the Count was in awe of his Countess and of her niece, my nurse. However this may be I know not. I do know that I was not more disturbed that day.

On the morrow I was still feverish having passed but a poor night. In the morning she visited me again, saying: “Fair Sir, I see but one way by which I may save you from that murderer at the Castle. He is my uncle, and were you but husband of mine he dare not touch you. Have you a mind to wed?”

Verily, this I had not thought of, but the thought left me warm and not cold. And yet I must hesitate for her sake. I dare not lest she regret. So I said:

“Truly, my Lady, the honor you speak of is far beyond my just deserts. Did I think you truly willing I should hurry on the match. But should you regret, nothing would be left for me but death. Let me therefore die the death at the hand of this dread Count rather than you should grant so great a boon and then repent.”

“Say no more,” said she. “I have said you shall not be harmed, and by God’s word no harm shall befall you.” So saying, without more ado, she sent for the priest who said mass and married us.

Great was the wrath of the Count, her uncle. But what was done could not be undone. When he was gone she turned her face to me in shame. “What must you think of me?” she said.

“If you will but trust me,” said I, “you will see that I think well of you. Before that you thus sacrificed your future for me I thought you an angel. My life shall be devoted to winning and keeping your love.”

“How do you know I do not love you now?” said she—and fled.

When our army came up and I was well again she had disappeared. I saw her no more for months, being detained from pursuing her by the war which came to an end but slowly. After that I had served King Louis at Peronne and had been taken into his service I heard much of her, but do what I would, could never come near her. At last, despairing, I went to the King

and confessed my plight and sought his Majesty's assistance. "What would you?" said the King.

"Do but let me see her, your Majesty," said I, "that I may at least have speech of her."

"That I will do right gladly," said he.

About a week thereafter I was sent for to the Royal Cabinet and entering found the King with my wife. "Did I not promise to bring you together?" said the King. "Take now thy wife, de Comines and teach her her duty. You may withdraw!"

I offered my hand to my Lady and we withdrew to an antechamber. Here she would fain have left me, but I said: "Lady I am your humble slave. Will you not listen to me?"

"Nay," said she, "I have said and done unmaidenly things and I am ashamed. Let me withdraw."

"Not so," said I, "your acts were acts only of pity which I would fain turn into acts of love if you will only listen."

"Men speak well of you," said she, "they tell me you are kind of heart and merciful and will spare my shame. But I ask not for pity. I will not be companion to a man who does not love me without pity, that I may be triumphant and without shame."

"That you may well be," said I, "if you will but listen."

"It is not ears but eyes shall convince me," said she.

"Set me any task," said I.

"Nay," she replied, "let me but see you. Do not pursue me. Let me see you in your daily work. I am to be Lady in Waiting to the Queen, and I may see you thus."

"You are harsh," said I, "What have I done to be treated so unkindly?"

"I will not listen," said she, stopping her ears with her fingers and running away.

For weeks thereafter I was condemned to see her daily but scarcely to speak to her. The King and Queen sought to throw us together but failed because

she would not. At last I despaired. I went to the King and asked that I might be allowed to depart to my estate in Flanders so that I need no longer be on the rack. To this the King replied: "Do but let me speak to her again!" to which I gave consent.

The next day I was sent for again to the King's Cabinet, and entering found her again. "Why will you not put an end to this severity?" said the King, turning to her. "The poor fool pines daily. He loses flesh. He sulks. He is as one distraught. Mend him or break him, but torture him no longer."

"He is my own husband," said she, her eyes flashing defiance.

"Surely," said the King, "treat him therefore as a man and not as a dog. Now leave me. I am weary of your quarrel."

Again we departed; as we reached the anteroom she whispered: "May I not do as I please with you?"

"You may indeed," said I, "but trample no longer upon my heart, I beseech you."

"Thou art but a poor fool," said she, "why not make me be good since I have loved thee from the first? Do I not love thy eyes and thy curly hair and thy straight back and even thy coat and hat. Surely I love thee, thou blind goose!"—and fled again. But this time I was too quick. I caught her and I have held her ever since, and with her good will as she declares and I believe. She has been my willing slave and I hers. Hath any man ever had a more devoted mate? Did she not visit me each day I spent in the iron cage at Loches? In rain, in fog, in sleet, in sunshine; still she came, and she is mine and I am hers, forever.

Death Valley

Away out in California, near the Nevada line, lies a lonely valley. No one lives in this valley very long; it is a very lonesome place. In the winter the thermometer goes down below freezing point at night and rises to eighty degrees during the day. This is the pleasant time of year. In the spring and fall violent wind storms sweep over the desert, for it is a desert—the Mohave Desert—and in the summer the hot wind blows, drying up every drop of moisture and baking the country as if it had been placed in a baker's oven. The few who must stay there get a leather-like skin from the heated wind and the glaring sun, with never a cloud to hide its pitiless rays. Sagebrush and greasewood are found here and there, and in the infrequent river bottoms a few willows are seen. Fissure springs, from deep faults in the earth's crust let out small streams of water from sources far remote; sometimes fit to drink; sometimes loaded with salts in solution and sometimes hot. Such a spring is that which gives rise to Willow Creek which rises among the niter hills of the Great Basin and empties into the Amargosa River a short distance below its source. Alas for the name! The Amargosa "River" turns out on examination to be a stream scarce large enough to turn a mill. After a run of less than 25 miles it sinks into the sands to rise no more. Shortly below this place we find Saratoga Springs and "Lakes." These "Lakes" are perhaps 10 feet in diameter. All along the banks of the Amargosa the water as it evaporates rapidly in this thirsty land leaves a white crust of salt, soda and borax. In many places, scattered over the desert, deposits of mixed salts have been left by evaporated water which glisten in the sun from a distance. As the weary traveler walks through them

the alkali rises in fine white clouds burning throat and nostril and biting the skin into sores.

Over this desert roams the dismal coyote—always hungry, an Ishmaelite. Kangaroo rats swarm in rocky spots; the side-winder threads his snaky way; and lizards and tarantulas scuttle to their holes to escape the traveler.

In 1849 the Bennett family wandered into this valley and perished, giving to the valley its name. All along the wagon tracks—for there are no roads—bottles, tin cans and the skeletons of abandoned animals mark the progress of civilization and the survival of the fittest. It is a weary land; over 400 feet below sea level; bounded by the black rocks of the Funeral Range on the northeast, the Kingston Range on the north, the Shadow Mountains on the southeast, the Avawatz Mountains on the south and the Telescope Range on the west. These mountains rise in some places to a height of 10,000 feet. The springs are far apart, from 30 to 90 miles, often with a very small flow and hard to find. At Cave Wells, for example, the traveler in search of water goes into a hole in the side of a cliff and descends a few steps to the margin of a shallow pool with no apparent overflow.

“When does your uncle come for you, Jack?” said her friend.

“To-morrow morning,” Jack replied.

Next morning her friend was getting breakfast when a knock sounded on the door. When the door was opened, a wiry, pale-faced man stood in front of her.

“Where is Jack’s kid?” he enquired.

“Upstairs in bed,” was the reply.

Without a word he brushed by her, mounted the stairs, opened the door, bent over the half-awakened girl, put his arms around her and kissed her.

“Is your name Jack, too?” he enquired. “You are a mighty nice-looking boy and I will love you and look after you for his sake. Now I must go. We will leave for the west at 10 to-morrow morning. I am ordered to the desert to spend the winter there in the out of doors for the sake of my health. Get yourself a corduroy suit with high-laced boots. Here is some money. I will

be here for you at nine-thirty. Good bye till then!" So saying, he turned, rushed down the stairs and out of the house.

"Did you ever see such a whirlwind?" said Jacqueline. "He thinks I am a boy, and he will be disappointed and not let me go. What shall I do?"

"Go as a boy," said her friend. "You are slim and can easily pass as a boy. I will help you get ready. Come along!"

Next morning when Uncle appeared Jack was ready, dressed in corduroy knickers, stout, high-laced shoes, short, thick corduroy coat and felt hat.

"Well, come along!" said Uncle, "We have just time to make the train."

At Salt Lake City they outfitted for the desert. Five burros were bought, two for riding and three for packing. Jack's burro was called Jenny. Jenny was a canny animal. She grunted at every step. Her progress might in some measure be likened to that of a drove of pigs, except that her grunts lacked the solidity and conviction which characterize the grunt of the real porker. Mexico is the real land of the burro. Here they are used to such an extent as freighters as to threaten the existence of the railroads. The Mexican will load his burros to their full capacity and at the stopping places let them graze. No food is provided except what they can pick up. If there should be no food and the animal starves he buys another since this is the cheapest plan.

They carried a light rifle and two Colt's revolvers, or "Guns" as they are called in the west. There was a tent, two blankets, a bucket, a frying pan, two large canteens, a spade, pick, axe, plenty of coffee and tea, canned baked beans, hard bread, bacon, butter and lard, some flour and feed for the burros.

Neither one could bake or shoot but Uncle remarked that there would be time enough to learn and plenty of teachers. Notwithstanding his quick and sometimes almost rough manner, Jack soon discovered that Uncle was growing fond of her and was really very kind. At first she was very tired as night drew near after a hard day's riding over the rough trails. They went slowly of necessity, for the burro is not a fast goer and dislikes hurry to an extreme. As the days went by she found her strength growing. He, too, appeared to benefit. They ate plain food, drank nothing but water, and coffee or tea, and retired early and slept soundly. Occasionally they stopped

at a settlement, ate a square meal, renewed supplies, had a bath and made ready for another trip.

In this way the winter passed rapidly. Jack learned to shoot, and, profiting from the directions of a good-natured miner, after several failures, they learned to make fair bread.

Jack's greatest trouble was her cowardice, because she felt sure her Uncle would detest in a boy what he might condone knowing her to be a girl. She made desperate efforts and finally succeeded in controlling her fears moderately well. The dislike she had for shooting was never overcome.

Most of all she enjoyed the evenings by the camp fire when the exertions of the day had not been so great as to compel early hours. Here she looked into his heart and found it clean and good.

There were plenty of indications that all the men one might meet were not of his kind. Bottles innumerable left along the way testified to the fact that though the desert might be dry the travelers were not.

They traveled down the post road from Milford to Delmar and from there struck across country, intending to cross the Hiko, Paranaga and Belted Ranges and strike the Amargosa Desert to the south. These ranges cover a very rough and broken country, and progress was slow and difficult. Several times they were lost, and only the compass finally enabled them to escape from the mountain tangle. The greatest difficulty was in the supply of water for the burros. Their own supply could easily be carried. Several times the burros were saved from death by the finding of one or two barrel cactus which were cut up and fed to them as both food and drink.

With all his good nature Uncle made her toe the mark. He did not believe in spoiling boys. They were generally lazy and he was determined Jack should do her full share of the work, but he did not always remember this. Being naturally lazy she resented being driven. She much preferred to lie around and read, or to lie abed and see him get breakfast, but he usually routed her out. He was anxious that she should grow strong and made her work in order that she might do so but uncomplainingly and as a matter of course he shouldered the heaviest part of the load. It may be imagined, therefore, that her regard for Uncle grew greater day by day. There was bread to make and he made it; the water grew short and he went without; the burros strayed

and he went after them,—not grudgingly but without complaint. She had heard of him through her father's talks many and many a time. She had learned of his goodness to her father; and here he was, unselfishly giving to her all he could give, freely and as a matter of course. Such conduct makes a friend of any generous-minded soul. It slowly converted her regard into devotion. She began to look for opportunities to serve him. To do anything for him became a joy.

They were nearing the Amargosa and were sitting at the camp fire one evening when he said: "Jack, you are the very nicest boy I ever knew. I thought your father was the finest man on earth but I have lost him forever. I have found you instead. I am selfish and I would like to have you both; but, oh, my dear boy! I am so glad to have found you." Jack said nothing but she turned her face to conceal the tears.

They had been many days on the road. That afternoon they crossed the Funeral Range into Death Valley. The rocks of this range are black, rough, crumbly and forbidding. It is a bad climbing ground for the rocks are rotten and afford very insecure support. As they were slowly and painfully groping their way down into the valley a rock upon which he was standing gave way and he came sliding down in an avalanche of stones and dirt. She saw at a glance that he was headed for a precipice and without hesitating a second threw herself in the way. He was stopped but she slid many feet, turning over and over and landed against another rock, just on the edge of the precipice, covered with stones and dirt. Hastily he tore the spade from the pack, rushed down and uncovered her. Her coat was torn and her shirt in rags. She was unconscious as he laid her on the ground and cleaned the dirt from hands and face and gave her water to drink. Slowly she came out of the daze to find him anxiously bending over her.

"Were you hurt?" said she.

"No," he replied, "see whether any of your bones are broken."

They camped at Saratoga Springs and from there traveled by easy stages to Daggett and thence to Los Angeles. All the way he was quiet, and she viewed him with apprehension. On the way east he sat beside her in the Pullman.

"Why did you not tell me you were a woman?" said he.

“I was afraid you would not take me, and I wanted to go.”

“Well, it’s too bad. I suppose now I must send you off to live with some one else.”

“Please don’t do that Uncle, I couldn’t bear it.”

“What can I do then? Get my sister to live with us?”

“Why yes, I suppose so. There are evil tongues. We must have some one.”

His sister saw at once that she must play the rôle of huckleberry, and felt no great eagerness, but good-naturedly consented at last, firmly resolved to aid fate as much as possible so that she might go back to her own work.

The play began with taking them to the theatre twice a week when sister was careful that Jack should sit next to brother. It continued by taking them to the country for the summer. Then they came back to the city again and missed the long walks and the pleasant companionship of the afternoons with nothing to do but exchange ideas. Then Uncle was called to Chicago on business for a week. This lengthened to two weeks. On returning he was so glad to see her that he kissed her and she impulsively returned the kiss and fled. How could a lonesome bachelor long resist such a combination of youth, beauty and love. There was a quiet wedding soon in which two hearts as well as two hands were united. They are not lovers, they are chums. He knows her thoughts and she his—they like each other.

The Professor's Story

When I was in college one of my professors was a rather old man who was fond of telling about his travels. He told me about several trips he had taken. Some of these stories were very interesting, for he had gone into many places outside the tourist's ordinary routes in order to study subjects in which he was particularly interested. One of these trips was a visit to Rome. It was taken to attend a Congress of Chemists that assembled there in the Palace of Justice, or Palazzo de Giustitia as the Italians call it, located on the right bank of the Tiber near the Castel de St. Angelo. His daughter, a beautiful girl of 21, accompanied him on the trip. They traveled on the Red Star Line to Vlissingen, or Flushing, and up the Scheldt to Antwerp.

The Congress was held in term time and he was limited to an absence of six weeks. There were two things which he particularly wished to see during this time. One of them was the iron mines of Elba. The ores found in these mines are hematites and contain some of the finest crystals of hematite that have ever been discovered. Elba was also, you will remember, the home of Bonaparte after he had been expelled from France for the first time. Here he ruled in petty state from the fifth of May, 1814, to the twenty sixth of February, 1815.

The second, and indeed the chief, object of his trip was to see the boracic acid *soffioni* at Lardrello. Here, it had been stated, jets of steam break forth from the earth in which small amounts of boracic acid are contained. This steam is carried into water, the boracic acid condensed with the steam, and the dilute solution thus obtained evaporated at a low temperature so as not

to again volatilize it. Ammonia and sulfureted hydrogen are also present and considerable amounts of ammonium sulfate come into commerce from this source. These statements which were so varied in character as to cause some suspicion of exaggeration had aroused his curiosity, only to be completely satisfied by first-hand information such as could be best obtained by a visit.

From Antwerp they traveled to Brussels and from there to Rome by express, by way of Milan. They expected to find it warm in Italy and left their heavy clothing at Antwerp to await their return. They traveled through the Italian Alps, however, and suffered from the cold until Rome was reached. The journey from Brussels was begun in the evening and the second night was passed on the way from Milan to Rome. No seats together were to be had in the train from Milan. The daughter found a good seat in the compartment reserved for women where there was room also for her father and where he joined her. Whenever the conductor came around he remonstrated with the Professor; but as the latter was comfortably established this was met by a stare of no comprehension and the slipping of a lira into the conductor's hand which ended the argument until the next conductor came around when the process must be repeated. It was, however, uniformly successful.

They approached Rome on the afternoon of a beautiful day in May. The whole surroundings were picturesque in the extreme. Black masses of masonry perched upon the hilltops, marking the sites of cities and towns, spoke eloquently of the reign of lawlessness only just passing away. They passed remains of tombs and caverns excavated in the hillsides—the marks of past civilizations. Everywhere, inside and outside of Rome, were foundations of buildings of the oldest masonry upon which a second structure had been erected, to be in turn destroyed and serve as the foundation of another erection, but still leaving visible remains. This was the country and these the places where Julius and Augustus Caesar lived and reigned, where Cicero spoke, where Cataline conspired, over which Hannibal roamed at will and where Fabian tactics were born. This was the land of the two Plinies, of Scipio the conqueror of Carthage, of Dante and Virgil; the sense of its antiquity grew and became overpowering.

They thought Italy the most beautiful country they had ever seen, “Why,” said the Professor, “As we traveled along I saw *Narcissus Poeticus* growing in the fields.”

They stopped at the Royal Hotel and were visited by a valet who proposed that he should take care of them during their stay, to which they assented. They occupied three rooms, two bedrooms and a sitting room. In the sitting room of a morning breakfast was prepared by the valet while they were dressing. Then they sat down to breakfast, the valet waiting on them. Lunch was served downstairs, but dinner was the great event of hotel life. The guests were expected to be on time but if delayed they murmured a perfunctory excuse to the Major Domo which was smilingly accepted. The cooking here was elevated to the dignity of a fine art. It was marvelous and sometimes spectacular; as when at the conclusion of a meal an ice was placed in a dish and this in another larger dish held high upon the waiter's outstretched hand, came in surrounded by blue flames, produced by pouring a little strong liquor into the outer vessel and setting fire to it. Upon another evening, after dinner, the guests were entertained with a very wonderful musical performance carried out by two men and a woman, the latter a very beautiful and accomplished Italian. It soon dawns upon the traveler that the modern Italian is descended from widely differing tribes, few of whom even look alike. Those we know best are swarthy, with black hair and wonderful eyes. There are many types beside this, and not a few light skins and blue eyes.

The Congress was divided into sections. The presiding officer of each section had been selected because of his accomplishments as a linguist. This was necessary, because there were four official languages in which papers might be presented and discussed: Italian, French, German and English. Two of the presiding officers were Germans: Georg Lunge, an accomplished technical chemist, who had been petted until his sense of proportion had been lost and he had become arrogant, and Wilhelm Ostwald, an equally accomplished and much more learned man and a great physical chemist, who was always polite and never was able to forget that he was a gentleman, first. But the sessions were found uninteresting by comparison. Rome itself was so absorbing. They soon gave up the sessions entirely and devoted all their time to exploring the city. The first trip was to the Colosseum. Here they secured a guide—quite an old man, with an English all his own—who declared that: “He was a Roman citizen and p-r-r-roud of it.” The Professor did not blame him in the least for this feeling. The old man proved to be a wonderful mine of information, most of it apparently accurate. He explained how the naval battles and other water

scenes were managed, how the crowds were protected from the sun and from rains, how the various orders of Romans came in and reached their seats, and showed them the dens where wild beasts were kept. In answer to a question as to how the stones of the amphitheatre were joined without mortar, he took them to a place where a broken corner showed the method of joining by means of a short iron rod leaded into both stones. While they were talking and the Professor was sketching he turned his head and found a policeman with sword and musket overlooking the performance, and especially the sketching, which it seemed was forbidden. But the guide set them at ease by remarking, pointing to the policeman: "a friend of mine."

Another afternoon was devoted to the famous Forum Romanum, the scene of so many speeches and so many triumphs, and, especially remembered, the speech of Antony over Caesar's dead body, reported by Shakespeare, and repeated and varied in interpretation by so many of the masters of the tragic art.

A third excursion was to the catacombs on the Appian Way. They were greeted here by a priestly-looking crowd of men one of whom enquired, pointing at them: "English?" Answered in the affirmative they were motioned aside until enough English had accumulated to make up a party and the burly and not over clean guide led them around. The catacombs were disappointing. The galleries are narrow, tortuous and unattractive. The remains of the art of that period though no doubt interesting as showing how art arose decayed and died, were not interesting to a modern. The conclusion was still more unattractive; for, on trying to find their conveyance they discovered that it had disappeared and they must find their way back afoot. But it was evening; they were walking over the road so many conquerors had trodden; under the soft Roman twilight with the monuments of the great dead on both sides of the way; they were glad the driver had fled and left them to walk.

One day was stolen for a swift excursion to Naples to see the museum. Here they stopped at Bertolini's Hotel, which is situated on the side of a hill far above the city level, with a splendid view. This is reached by going through a doorway into a tunnel at the end of which is a lift. At the top a splendid hotel with this superb view of the bay and of Vesuvius.

There was not time for a thorough examination of the treasures of the museum, but enough was seen to verify and enlarge some statements the Professor had made in a history he was then writing. The examples of metal working were very illuminating, showing as they did in some magnificent examples from Pompeii how little modern art excelled the art of that day except in speed and cheapness of working.

Returning to Rome they discovered that the trip to Elba and to Lardello had been abandoned because of a strike among the employees on the railway and steamboat; but the Professor declared that he had come to see Lardello and he would walk there if necessary. The next day they started for Pisa. Most of the route lay along the rocky coast of the Mediterranean through the most beautiful scenery in the world. The road runs along a shelf on the rocks with many tunnels. And the smoke! Ah, the smoke! Oh, the smoke! It gets into the eyes, the nose, the mouth, the ears, over the face and down the back. There is no avoiding it and no escape is possible. They arrived at Pisa about 11 P. M. and were met at the hotel by the proprietor with the question: "You would like a room?" "Yes, two rooms." A shrug, and then: "I do not know what I shall do; we have but two rooms; one has three beds and the other four beds."

"The answer is easy," said the Professor, "My daughter will take the room with three beds, I will take the room with four beds." When they were escorted to the rooms by the proprietor, the head porter, the maid and the facchini or porters and the doors were opened on the overflowing hospitality of seven beds for two travelers, a hearty laugh broke from every throat; a laugh is the same in all languages.

Pisa is not very inspiring. The famous leaning tower leans because the foundations were poor, and the Baptistery is built of old tombstones and other stolen pieces of marble from which the thieves had not decency enough to chisel away the inscriptions. This thievery seems to have been a habit in the days which we see through the fogs of romance.

The next day they turned back and retraced their steps for part of the way to Cecina where they transferred to the road to Volterra. This town is situated on the frowning heights above the railway station, where a crowd of people; drivers, porters and others was assembled. The Professor accosted a hack driver in English. To this there was no reply but a shrug of the shoulders.

Then he tried German, French and Latin in succession, all in vain. As they were about giving up in despair a voice from behind them, or from Heaven, said: "You would like to go to Lardrello? You are interested in boracic acid?"

"I have come all the way from America to see it," said the Professor, "so you may judge whether I am interested." Introductions followed and cards were exchanged. Their friend was Prince Conti, son-in-law of Count Lardrello and the manager of the works. He told the driver what was required; gave him instructions where to take the travelers for the night and what they would like to eat and promised to meet them at the works next day. He too, it seemed, had been attending the Congress and was just returning.

They traveled over a beautiful country covered with olive orchards, with pale yellowish-green foliage, to a country inn. Here everything was primitive and old-fashioned to the last degree, but *clean*. There were tile floors and the beds were of wrought iron in filagree,—beautiful pieces of workmanship.

Next morning they reached the works in a desolate valley over which clouds of steam hovered. They were met and welcomed by the Prince who apologized for not being able to open the Palace for them as the family were away and the servants dispersed for the summer.

The natural *soffioni*, they discovered, had failed to give a sufficient yield and were now supplemented by wells sunk as are petroleum wells in Pennsylvania. One of the new developments had been the striking of steam at a pressure of sixty pounds in some of the wells. These wells were capped and the steam led through a boiler containing a purifying agent to remove the sulfureted hydrogen, after which it was used to run a steam engine which in turn actuated mills to grind the boracic acid and borax produced. After going through the works the Prince was good enough to present the young lady with a bouquet of flowers and they said good-bye. The use of steam from Mother Earth to run a steam engine was, the Professor said, an entirely new idea not used, so far as he knew, anywhere else in the world, and suggested a possible method of keeping alive in those times we may possibly expect as our fuels disappear. It may then be necessary to drive

deep wells to tap the supply of heat now lying far below the surface in most places and only reaching through the crust in a few.

My Friend Zahn

I am a very ordinary person with some rather remarkable acquaintances. It is my purpose to give here some account of these men and women—for they are of both sexes—and incidentally to describe some of the remarkable discoveries they have made.

It was my good fortune to become well acquainted with several of these personages—for they are remarkable enough to be so called—while I was a student in a mid-western college for both sexes. Being a man of sufficient means and a bachelor with a taste for scientific studies, I have had leisure to attend many scientific conventions; and here I have been able to make the acquaintance of many other persons of brain power and industry sufficient to lead them to eminence. I flatter myself that I have, by reason of an agreeable personality, obtained an unusual knowledge of the work they have accomplished. I will admit that some of these men and women have a very limited supply of polished manners, and one or two are almost without any of the qualifications necessary in a member of polite society.—But this will develop as the story progresses.

I first met Samuel Zahn as a fellow freshman. His was a most engaging personality, for he is kind, witty and brainy. He took the lead in the class from the first day in college and was the most popular member. Needless to say he was at once chosen President of the class, and President he remains to this day. He is over six feet tall, with large limbs and a big head; since leaving college he has gained weight and improved in appearance. I visited him at his home in a large western city five years ago and we spent several

days together, talking far into the nights; and during this time he had much to say about various phases of his work in biology, of which he is an enthusiastic student.

“Why is it Brown,” he enquired, “that all living beings must grow old and die? This is true of all plants and all animals. There must be some chemical reason for this universal fact.

“Before following out my line of reasoning, Brown, perhaps I should first recall your attention to the method of scientific discovery. We are accustomed, as you are aware, when traveling into new ground to form first an hypothesis as an explanation of the facts known to us. Beginning with this hypothesis, we first reason out the consequences which must follow if the hypothesis should be the real explanation. We then proceed to test these consequences by experiment. We then reason out other necessary consequences of the hypothesis and proceed further with our tests. If the results of our tests confirm the hypothesis it presently becomes a theory and in course of time a law.

“I have formed a great many hypotheses to account for the ageing of plants and animals, but under the test of experiment these have all broken down one after another. Recently, however, it occurred to me that perhaps the ageing might be due to the formation of resinous substances in the tissues by the combination of two substances one contained in the food the other in the tissues. You will remember that the insoluble resin, bakelite, is formed by the union of an aldehyde and a phenol under suitable temperature conditions. If, now, the aldehyde like body formed part of the tissue, and the phenol were contained in the food and passed unchanged into the circulation, we should have slow combination and the formation of hard material—perhaps also material in the form of fibers and therefore flexible—within the tissues, which would cause them to harden and stiffen, inducing the other changes we ascribe to old age.

“If now these phenol bodies are contained in the plant and animal juices constituting our foods they must be contained in those that are short lived in largest amount, and it should be possible to bring on old age much more rapidly by feeding short lived plants. For this purpose I used first oat straw, but I found this did not produce the desired effect. On further consideration it seemed unlikely that it should: for the ripe, and therefore dead, straw

would contain only the resin and neither aldehyde nor phenol. I therefore used green oat straw and found that this brought on old age rapidly when fed to dairy cows with no other food. I then tried various additions to the green oat straw with the object of finding some substance capable of uniting with and destroying the phenol. This I have at last succeeded in finding; and I am now in possession of a reagent which will so far destroy any of these phenols contained in food, that old age is indefinitely arrested. This as you will see places a dreadful responsibility in my hands. This is not the Secret of Perpetual Youth exactly, for I cannot so far restore youth to the aged—I can only arrest decay. By feeding this antidote to a baby it may remain a baby forever. Or it may be allowed to reach any desired age and then forced to cease developing indefinitely. I will confess to you that I feel dismayed by this heavy responsibility. What do you think I should do? What is my duty?”

“This is such an extraordinary story, Zahn,” I replied, “that I think, in fairness, you should first give some proof that you are not in error in thinking your discovery a real one; and since considerable time must necessarily pass before any satisfactory demonstration of this kind can be made perhaps we had better not further discuss the matter at present.”

“Spoken with your usual clearheadedness,” he rejoined. “I must confess, however to a certain amount of disappointment in your lack of faith in accepting my conclusions.”

To this I made no rejoinder, thinking that the less the subject was discussed the better.

He then informed me that he had invited two friends to lunch with us. “I am much interested in them,” he said, “because I believe they are much interested in each other. They are very interesting people, and I want you to know them.”

Shortly before one they arrived. The man was approximately about fifty years of age and rather above the medium height; he was well-built and walked like a soldier. His hair was only slightly gray; his nose was straight and well-formed. There was about him a certain air of gentility, and his manner was pleasant and courteous. The lady was at least twenty years younger. She was the most beautiful creature I had ever met, and her manner was alert and full of charm. They came in together, and there was

no possibility of doubting their interest in each other. But they were both so genuinely interested in their host and in me that this mutual understanding seemed pleasant to both of us. He was introduced as John Valient, a successful lawyer and she as Helen Henderson.

At table we were waited on by Mrs. Frains, Sam's housekeeper, a dear, motherly old lady with white hair, kind eyes and a fair complexion. Sam introduced her to us, and treated her as in every way an equal. Miss Henderson sat at his right, Valient at his left and I opposite.

During the meal Sam informed us that he had recently given some attention to nutrition and had come to the conclusion that condiments played a much more important rôle than had hitherto been assigned to them. He had studied these therefore with some attention and had compounded one which he thought we would find very agreeable. He proceeded to extract a bottle from a near by closet; from a medicine dropper inserted through the cork he dropped a single drop upon our fish.

"It is very strong," he remarked, "and more than a single drop would be too much. If you wish I will give a bottle of it to each one of you provided you will promise to use a single drop at each meal until it is all used. According to my calculations this will take a little over nine years, for there are 500 cubic centimeters in the bottle and each cubic centimeter is equal to twenty drops."

After eating the fish, which was delicious, we readily promised and received each a bottle. I may remark here that I became very fond of the relish, and now, after the lapse of five years, the bottle is nearly half full, thus showing how accurate were his calculations.

"I wish," said Miss Henderson to Zahn, "that you would tell Mr. Brown about your agricultural catalyts. I think this a very entertaining story."

"Why certainly," he replied, "I shall be delighted."

"You must know, Brown," he said, addressing me, "that there are a large number of chemical substances which are called catalyts. I can best illustrate what this means by giving two examples. If potassium chlorate be heated it melts and begins to give off bubbles of oxygen gas. If, however, we first pulverize the chlorate and add to it a mere pinch of very finely powdered manganese dioxid and mix the two very thoroughly and then heat

the mixture, oxygen will again come off but at so low a temperature that the chlorate does not even melt, and much more rapidly.

“In the manufacture of ‘Crisco’ and other lard substitutes from liquid oils by pumping hydrogen through the oil in closed vessels, so long as only these two substances are present no combination takes place and the pressure increases. But if a small amount of finely divided nickel be added combination at once begins, the melting point of the oil rises and the pressure falls.

“We once supposed that many chemical substances found in minute amount in the ashes of plants were not of importance, but it has lately been asserted that this is not true and that manganese in particular plays an important part in plant economy, acting as a catalyst. I have verified this fact and have proceeded to examine the action of different manganese compounds in order to determine which is most active. The acetate functions well, the hydrosol better but colloidal manganese is by far the best. In any considerable amount this acts as a violent poison but in homeopathic doses it functions as a vigorous stimulant. Using this reagent as a hypodermic I have obtained astonishing results. I have one stalk of Indian corn on my farm treated in this way which measures forty feet in height and has seven ears, each over a foot long and perfectly set, with grains well on toward ripeness. Watermelons the size of hogsheads are readily produced and we have canteloupes, cucumbers and tomatoes as large as nail kegs. I have used the kohlrabi for several years as a source of winter forage for my cattle, slicing them before feeding. Treated in this way heads as large as barrels are readily grown, as much as forty tons per acre being an ordinary yield. I have in consequence been able to quadruple the size of my herd without devoting more acreage to the growing of forage. I have not entirely succeeded in increasing the oat and wheat crop because of the difficulties in the way of successful wholesale hypodermic injection. I have made a somewhat promising beginning, however, by successfully inoculating chrysanthemum with the aid of the aphid which preys on them. You know that this aphid punctures the outer cuticle with his proboscis and drinks the sap. Acting on this knowledge I have first sprayed the aphid with a dilute colloidal manganese and dried them rapidly with a current of warm air. The colloid adheres to the outside of their beaks and gently stimulates. When the beak is inserted the plant at once is inoculated. The aphid is then destroyed

by the application of whale oil soap or other appropriate insecticide and the plant develops to an enormous size producing blossoms as large as a lady's summer straw hat. They are indeed marvelous.

"I have also begun some experiments upon animals but the effect here seems to be even more poisonous. Another idea has, however, occurred to me which gives promise of a very great success. You know that caffeine is a mild stimulant to the human race, and acting on this lead I have tried a number of stimulants, winding up with virulent poisons. One of these containing arsenic combined with strychnine, cocaine and selenium has been injected into calves from my herd which are now, at six weeks, as large as their mothers. Unfortunately this growth has been accompanied by the development of a disagreeable odor which makes them unpleasant neighbors. I fear I shall be forced to find a substitute for the selenium in order to avoid this but I have no doubt of final success."

During this recital any conversation had become impossible; in fact we were reduced to a state of coma and walked from the table like well-trained somnambulists without uttering a word.

In the evening I accompanied Zahn to a lecture he was to deliver before the Society of Facultative Anaerobists. It appeared that these people had associated themselves for the purpose of further studying those organisms which develop either in an atmosphere of oxygen or of one devoid of it. In the latter case they decompose some substance contained in the solution and assimilate the oxygen it contains. The lecture was to be delivered at the society headquarters over a grocery store. The entrance was on a side street in the rear. There was a light over the entrance and the hall was gained by mounting a steep pair of stairs. We found the assembled anaerobists busily at work under the chairmanship of a lanky individual in corduroy trousers. Upon our entrance the proceedings were at once suspended to allow the lecture to proceed. Zahn was escorted to the platform with much deference and began as follows:

"Fellow Truthseekers:—It is with some hesitation that I venture to appear before you to make my small contribution to your proceedings. I am well aware of the labors of some members of this illustrious society, and feel considerable diffidence in appearing before you. I shall confine my remarks to two themes: The first will be a contribution to the technology of

inoculation. I have had considerable experience of the difficulty and danger of inoculating savage animals, and the first part of my paper merely describes the technique which I have found successful in such cases. I have here an inconspicuous gun which enables us to effect inoculation at a distance and with ease and certainty. The projectile consists of a hollow needle with two sheet metal flanges surrounding it acting like a piston in the cylinder of the gun. The inoculating liquid is sucked into the needle by its capillarity. On inserting a metal sphere filled with liquefied carbon dioxide into this cylinder and pressing this trigger, a needle penetrates the capsule, liberates the carbon dioxide, which instantly is converted into gas and drives the projectile from the gun. The needle has sufficient force to penetrate the skin until the first of the flanges is reached. This instantly stops it and the shock forces the liquid into the wound. The outside of the needle should first be coated with an antiseptic to prevent the entrance of skin bacteria.”

This contribution was greeted with great applause and the gun was seized by a female with a black eye which she declared had been due to the hoof of a mule—fortunately unshod. After the confusion had partly subsided the chairman rapped for order and Zahn proceeded to read his second paper:

“You are of course aware,” he began, “that during the world war the supply of glycerin became insufficient and that it was discovered that the addition of some sodium sulfite to a sugar solution which was seeded with the yeast plant altered the direction of the fermentation and caused the formation of large amounts of glycerin—sometimes as much as 30 per cent of the product. No careful study of the effect of this addition upon the yeast plant itself seems to have been made. I have now taken up this study and have reached some startling conclusions. Such organisms so produced seem to have lost many of their original characteristics. Ordinary *saccharomyces cerevisiae*, for example, grown under these abnormal conditions will no longer produce normal yeast fermentation. The progeny of the original cells break, and we have the same sort of variation that is ordinarily obtained in raising plants from seed. By varying the nature of the disturbing substance; that is by replacing the sodium sulfite by other reagents, I have succeeded in producing still other modifications which have interesting properties economically important.

“On this slide, which we will now project by the lantern, we have a photograph of an organism capable of turning waste molasses into ethyl

chloride which is much used as a local anaesthetic and may be used instead of ether. It is necessary to add sufficient salt to the solution to supply the chlorine and the sodium remains behind as sodium carbonate supplying that necessary product of the chemical industry at a price defying competition.

“Here we have the photograph of another modified organism capable of absorbing carbon dioxide from mixed gases containing it and building up starch in sunlight much after the manner of chlorophyll in the plant. The synthetic starch so produced differs in no particular from that found in plants and is obtained in large amount very cheaply from the waste gases given off by our stoves and furnaces. The supply of such material is very large and the starchy food that in this way may become available destroys at once all possibility of future famine and all necessity of raising wheat, oats, barley, potatoes or other starchy foods. I hope before long to be able to announce the discovery of other forms able to produce albumen and other proteids directly from the atmospheric nitrogen, so as to solve for all time the possibility of future starvation.”

This paper was greeted by cheering and immense enthusiasm. The chairman in proposing a vote of thanks said that the society had now amply justified the hopes of its founders and that this would long be marked as a red letter day in its history.

I walked home with Zahn tired with so many wonders. The next morning I overslept and was late for my train so that there was no opportunity for any further conversation. I have not seen my host since that time until last week. I then made a singular and most distressing discovery.

I had noticed that most of my shirts were frayed at the wristbands. I needed some new shirts and proceeded to select them. Judge my surprise when I discovered that my old friend Zahn was waiting on me! I of course accosted him by name, only to be met by a blank stare and a firm denial of acquaintance. He assured me that his name was Smith and that he knew no one by the name of Zahn. I asked for the proprietor of the store and told him my story only to be greeted by an incredulous stare. The proprietor assured me that Smith came to the store under that name with fine recommendations from previous employers, and that they had no doubt whatever that he was as represented. I can only suppose that Zahn had lost his mind through overstudy and with it his memory. I have noticed that

neither I myself nor either of the other participants in that famous lunch, now five years ago, appears a day older, and I am dreading the exhaustion of my bottle and the slow onset of old age.

Just Samuel Jones

Samuel Jones was an energetic as well as a very careful young man. He had inherited a small sum of money from his father. It was his purpose to use so much of this as was necessary in completing his education; the remainder was to be carefully invested as a nest egg for the reserve he intended to create which he spoke and thought of as The Dam. The idea back of this name was that if the Dam were big enough and were full it would keep the mill going for some time should the springs run dry.

Sam was careful in other ways also. He laid careful plans each morning so that no time need be wasted. If the day was cool he put on a heavy suit; if cloudy he wore rubbers and carried an umbrella. If the temperature rose suddenly after such a beginning and the sun shone brightly, he had at least done his part and this consoled him for the suffering he must endure. This disposition subjected Sam to the ridicule of his unmarried sister, Tilly, who acted as his housekeeper. Tilly was of a very different build. No one ventured to call Tilly careful—she was conspicuously careless. She had a pretty foot and loved to buy new shoes, but she often dressed in a hurry, and her shoes, having been discarded in a hurry, were not readily matched. In consequence, she sometimes appeared at breakfast with a shoe upon the right foot and a slipper on the left. This impropriety filled Sam with anguish. Perhaps this difference in disposition was one of the reasons for their affection, for they were very fond of each other and they led a very happy life.

Sam had a poor opinion of college men. Part of this low rating was no doubt prejudice and part was due to the fact that he was not a college man himself. He saw very clearly, however, that many college men acquire only a fine polish. The process fails to get enough paint on the rough wood of the foundation to hide the coarse grain which shows through in all its crudity. He had also taken note of his own rather brusque manner, and laid it, correctly, to the lack of those opportunities which come to the college man unsought. Anxious to repair this defect he became precise and a trifle stilted. This Tilly was not slow to notice and criticize. Tilly loved college boys and their ways. She listened with attention to their songs and was up on all their pranks. Their escapades amused her and she forgave their faults. She knew them well for they lived in a college town.

Back of all Sam's spur to action was a love of chemistry. He became enamoured of it in High School where Steele's Fourteen Weeks was the text-book. Beginning by pouring vinegar on baking soda in his mother's kitchen, he had managed to study carefully a good many chemical substances so that his knowledge was much broader and deeper than that obtained by most college students. As the lumberman notices all the straight trees large enough for sawing so Sam tagged all objects with formulae. Water was H_2O ; vinegar $C_2H_4O_2$; Cream of tartar ($CHOH COOH$, $CHOH COOK$); and sugar $C_{12}H_{22}O_{11}$. After the death of their mother Sam had fitted up a laboratory in the attic and hung out the shingle of an analytical chemist. The income obtained in this way being too small he conceived the idea of adding to it by the concoction of various specialties, and Jones' Talcum Powder, Jones' Velvet Cream and Jones' Tooth Paste made their appearance on the shelves of neighboring druggists and were spoken of in terms of praise by those who had used them. These had been supplemented by various perfumes which found favor with the weaker sex and became the foundations of a business which was steadily increasing. Into this scene of happiness and peaceful prosperity Fate dropped several bombs.

BOMB THE FIRST

Sam and Tilly loved the movies. They formed a background of romance to their prosaic lives. They read, eagerly, all they could find in print about the stars of moviedom and were well acquainted with the features of the prominent actors. Twice a week they attended, rain or shine. As this involved long walks in bad weather they had, with the dawn of prosperity, invested in a Ford.

It was a windy night in October. There was a threat of rain in the air as the sullen clouds drifted past over the moon. As they returned to the car, which had been left in a side street, a tiny muffled wail greeted them: "Gracious! it's a cat," said Tilly. "Good Lord! it's a baby!" It was wrapped in an old, frayed, woolen blanket. They took it home—what else could they do?—and Tilly unwrapped it in her warm room. It was clean and warm and dry, and its clothing, though of the plainest material and somewhat worn, was also clean. Tilly declared it was a darling. She sent Sam for a bottle and some of the best milk, fed the child and covered her warmly in a large arm chair which was pushed against the bed so that she might hear the little one move in the night. Tilly declared the little girl had aristocratic features. She fell violently in love with her and declared she would not give her up. Sam smiled and agreed. He seldom opposed Tilly, though he felt somewhat doubtful of the propriety of keeping the baby. The little one grew apace. She soon became the central sun of the household about which Sam and Tilly revolved—two obedient satellites.

The household duties soon became too great for Tilly, and Elizabeth Tillicum was sent for. Elizabeth was a New Jersey product, redolent of the hills that border the Delaware. Her hair was sandy—the color of New Jersey sand. Her eyes were blue—the color of the blue water of the Atlantic which rolls over the New Jersey sand beaches, though this water is often green; and her freckles were—just plain brown freckles. I am not saying Elizabeth was beautiful—she was not. She agreed with everyone; she was quite unable to contradict; indeed her acquiescence was almost slavish. In size she was opulent. It seemed doubtful when she sat down whether some portion of her anatomy might not spill over on the floor but this never

actually happened. With all her disposition to conciliate she persisted in moving slowly, and all the alleged work that she performed was performed at a uniform slow speed. Some critics averred that she did not work—she lolloped. They said that when she did do work it was so poorly done that it must first be undone and then done over again. However this may be, Elizabeth steadfastly, slowly and pleasantly pushed her way through the world. But she was not a bomb, she was not even a torpedo.

Very few people can be reformed by preaching at them, object lessons are more effective. Her own carelessness was well known to Tilly and made her secretly admire Sam's precision and half despise Elizabeth's sloppy work. The coming of the baby brought a change. Tilly read up on the care of babies in a volume entitled "The Feeding and Care of Children." This learned work explained the overwhelming importance of cleanliness. It detailed the various minute bugs which lurk in the air, water and soil ready to seize and carry off the unsuspecting child. From a heedless maiden, Tilly was rapidly transformed into the veriest martinet, watching for the least speck of impurity to pounce upon and destroy it. Everything the baby ate was sterilized, and the bottles, spoons and plates scalded assiduously. Toward this campaign of cleanliness the baby herself manifested a cynical indifference. She threw the bottle on the floor. She drew her spoon through her hair, and after crawling through all the dirt attainable, rubbed her grimy hands over her half-cleared plate and then thrust the chubby paws down her throat. Such behaviour was *anathema maranatha* and filled Tilly with despair.

Sam was at first far from being charmed by the dirt and disorder which the child insisted upon, but she soon vanquished him. Her velvet skin, lovely color and wide open smile would have melted a stone, and Sam soon became her slave. In return she manifested an ardent preference for his society; crowed when he came home, howled when he left, insisted on sitting in his lap, thrust her fingers into his eyes, nose and ears, pulled his hair and showed not the slightest regard for his privacy or the ordinary courtesies of life. Sam was reformed in spite of himself. For the sake of peace he put up with rumpled hair, moist and slimy kisses and greasy fingerprints on his coat. Such is the mollifying discipline babies hand around in humanizing their elders.

The naming of the baby had been a dreadful ordeal, and nearly ended in a rupture between Sam and Tilly.

“We do not know her name,” said Sam, “so we had better give her one which is merely descriptive; then when her real name is divulged there will be less temptation to ignore it. I propose to call her Monday October Jones until we discover her real name. This is descriptive of the day of the week and the month she came to us.”

“She shall have no such barbarous name,” said Tilly. “You may as well call her Man Friday at once. I will not have any such name. She is going to have a pretty name. Monday October Jones: the idea! I shall call her Arma:

Arma virumque cano
Trojae qui primus ab oris

Don’t you remember that pretty verse Jimmy Case sings?”

Tilly’s words had an air of finality. She had been a bit uncertain herself until Sam put in an oar. There was another rhyme which sang through her consciousness making her undecided. It was:

Gaudeamus igitur
Juvenes dum sumus

that she had heard the college boys sing. But on the whole she inclined toward Arma, for Gaudeamus did not sound like a female. So the baby was named Arma Virumque Jones.

Arma was a romantic little soul. She thirsted for the unusual and wonderful. As she grew to girlhood she invested those dear to her with imaginary virtues. Tilly was a lovely and stately lady and Sam the personification of all that was noble and good. She was a beautiful girl, with curly brown hair and a clean mind. With her twelfth birthday began her affairs of the heart. Her first flame was a beautiful Italian boy who dwelt in an old house in the alley. This flame was quenched when she encountered him after he had consumed a larger ration of garlic than was usual. The next conflagration was started by the grocer’s boy, but this was quenched when she overheard him swear. This was followed by a passion for a young and rather dull divine who never dreamed of his conquest, so that it died of inanition.

BOMB THE SECOND

The three were sitting in the living room one evening in June. Sam and Tilly were reading and Arma was getting out her lessons, when a resounding knock on the door was heard, and a great big, strong, jolly man burst in, shook hands with Sam and noisily proclaimed how glad he was to see “this darn old fraud” once more.

Sam’s face lighted with pleasure as he welcomed him and introduced him as “Billy Gesundheit, my old friend and comrade in Pittsburgh.”

“My word, what a name!” thought Tilly, “But what a fine looking man. He seems too good to be true.” This was during her trip upstairs to inspect the guest room where he was to spend the night.

Sam had lived two years in the smokehouse city as chemist to a young struggling steel plant. Before he left this puny infant industry had begun putting on the seven league boots of manhood. At this time Gesundheit was a hearty young workman to whom Sam took a fancy. This was vigorously reciprocated; Sam was carried off to Billy’s home and introduced to his widowed mother who was a wonderful housekeeper. She became interested in Sam at once—for was he not a friend of her Billy?—sewed on his buttons, darned his socks, and wound up by taking complete possession. Sam soon moved into their spare room and, as the homely phrase has it, “she ate him and slept him.”

Billy informed them that he had risen in rank considerably since Sam’s departure and was now acting as manager of the works. He had come to New York on business and must soon leave for home; he expected to make frequent visits, however, and here he looked at Tilly, and he would not fail to visit them as often as possible. He also informed them that to-morrow was a holiday for them; he was to take entire charge, manage all details and pay all expenses; all they need do was to enjoy themselves as much as possible.

After breakfast next morning Billy produced a map of the city for each member of the party. “A taxicab is coming at eight,” he began, “to take us

to the place where our excursion starts. I'm going to walk part of the way; the rest of you may do so or ride, just as you please."

"Where are we going?" said Tilly.

"We are going to circumnavigate the city," said Billy. "I doubt whether you know your own town. Most people do not. If we first go around it, and then go through all the streets and alleys you will know it on the outside at least. After we get through we will quiz one another on the names of the streets and alleys and their location. It is good fun and has a use beside."

For about a mile the city line ran along the middle of a highway. It was not a well paved highway. There were stones, tin cans and piles of rubbish to be dodged. Then the line led through an orchard. Here Billy got out, inviting the others to go with him, but only Tilly accepted the invitation. The others followed the road, agreeing to wait for the pedestrians at a point further along, while the foot passengers gracefully climbed the fence. They had not gone more than a few hundred feet among the trees, which were old and decayed, before they caught sight of a house ahead. Sitting on the back porch in a hickory rocking chair was an ancient lady, clad in calico, rocking gently to and fro while knitting a pair of socks. As the travelers drew near, she looked up and said:

"I'm knitting these socks for my son. He don't like wool next his skin, so I use cotton, but I have an awful time getting the right kind of thread. If the thread is too coarse, he says they look like gunny bags and if it is too fine the socks are not warm enough. He is very pertickler, my son is. Maybe you know him; his name is Winterbottom; first name Jeremiah, after his father. He's well known in Wilmington. Don't you know him?"

"No," said Billy, sitting down on the edge of the porch and making room for Tilly beside him, "I don't know him but I hear he is a very fine man. I hope you will tell us more about him. What is his business?"

"Making flat irons. What's yours?"

"I make iron and steel."

"I don't see then why you don't know him. You got a nice lookin wife."

"Thank you, I think so too," said Billy, while Tilly blushed.

“Why did you let her think we were married?” said Tilly, after they had left the old lady behind.

“Well I kinda wish we were, and I hoped she only had the news a little ahead of time.”

“You are certainly a fast worker.”

“Sure, I no sooner saw you than I picked you. I can always make up my mind quickly, and I’m after you from now on.”

This made Tilly laugh, but she did not seem displeased.

They picnicked in a grove near the edge of town and then finished the circuit. Then they navigated all the streets and alleys and returned home to quiz one another all that evening. They were all surprised to find how much they had learned about the city.

Billy’s visits followed one another in quick succession. He knew his own mind, as he had said, and Tilly’s inclined to him more and more. When Sam awoke to the state of affairs he knew the second bomb had fallen and might burst at any minute.

BOMB THE THIRD

Arma's first loves were merely fancies. Having no substantial foundation they died as soon as born. Sam and Tilly had made no secret of her origin and she was spared a shock when she learned it of those pests of society whom, like the poor and Congress, we have always with us. She was a great reader and devoured all the books she could obtain. Among these was Charlotte Bronte's story of "The Professor." With the reading of this story a new point of view dawned upon her. She had before this looked upon Sam as immeasurably older and belonging to a disappearing age. But it appeared that a difference of ages was not so important as she had imagined, indeed might be an advantage from many points of view. Her previous flames had been boys, except for the divine, and he was a man of no perception—not worth considering. Besides, Sam had money—almost always a consideration with girls, who are nearly always full of worldly wisdom. Sam had become a possibility. As she studied him further he became a probability. She grew shy and a trifle coquettish. But Sam for a long time took no notice. He was absorbed in other matters.

Arma was, of course, very much interested in Tilly's love affair as it developed. She viewed it with much favor. The same worldly wisdom which told her that Sam was desirable from a matrimonial point of view, told her also that if Tilly should go to Pittsburgh Sam must more fully depend upon her. She became interested in cooking and studied all Sam's needs. Tilly was studying Billy at the same time. Arma secretly began to resent any interference with Sam—he was her property. She pampered him like a born mother—which she was.

Gradually but unconsciously Arma revealed her new set of ideas to Tilly who was not lacking in perception; but Tilly made no sign—she was relieved. For Sam's welfare was dear to her, and here were other hands to take up the tasks she must lay down. She became Arma's co-conspirator, gradually resigning to her the primacy in Sam's affairs which she had hitherto kept as her own.

As Arma became absorbed in Sam, she began to manifest an interest in his work and asked many questions. It was pleasant to teach a pupil so bright,

so much interested and so beautiful—for Sam could not help but notice her beauty. There were others who saw it also. The young men began to call and she was not annoyed at first; but few of them interested her very long. They knew so little. One day she betrayed herself. One of these boys had bored her for an hour before he departed and she met Sam in the passage.

“Well, has he gone?” said Sam.

“Yes, he has,” she replied, “and I am so glad, I like you much better.” And these words were accompanied by a look which would have awakened and galvanized an anchorite, and then she blushed a rosy red and fled.

There are really two bombs in this chapter. Arma’s bomb was a copy of “The Professor,” Sam’s bomb was the look Arma gave him when she blushed.

BOMB THE FOURTH AND LAST

It came the next morning while Arma was concocting a tapioca pudding—one of Sam's favorites. There was a ring at the front door and a well-dressed lady entered and asked: "Does Samuel Jones live here?"

"Yes," said Arma.

"Are you the little girl they found in their auto?"

"Yes," said Arma, wonderingly.

"Then I am your mother."

"Why did you give me away?"

"Your father deserted me and I was penniless. I have been poor ever since until quite recently, too poor to claim you. An uncle in California died last month and left me his money. I have been out settling his estate and I am just back. I want you to go with me."

"No," said Arma, "I cannot go with you but I can see you very often, and I am so glad I have a mother to love." Then they fell into each others arms in tears.

When Arma told her story at lunch the others gasped. She continued: "I think I must go to her." Then Sam gasped: "My God! I'll be all alone. Get her to come here, Arma, I can't bear to have you go."

Now wasn't Arma a sly puss? And she did not go, Sam went to her. He told her how much he loved her. She listened sagely and said: "yes, she liked him pretty well. She thought she might like to stay with him." And she did. And after awhile Sam discovered that she had been madly in love with him all the time—but he did not discover this for a long time, she was a woman and did not tell all she knew for awhile. She grew more fond of Sam every day and now she tells him everything—almost.

Fat and Lean

This story was told by lame Lewellyn Sangster to his aunt Margaret, uncle Fred, cousin Anita and Sam the hired man.

Nan Heberlein and Lula Manting were fast friends. They were fond of meeting at each others' homes and pretending to sew; sometimes they did sew; sometimes they promptly adjourned and went to the movies; sometimes they called in their lady friends who were of the same order of busy, and played 500, or bridge, or some other game; but always they talked; and laughed; and ate. They were not singular people: they fitly represented the average American lady who does most of her own work, feeds and dresses her children and sends them to school, and in the afternoon finds an hour or more to relax.

Nan was tall and slim, Lula was getting plump—at least so her friends called it; her unfriends said she was purse. But no one was so conscious of her too great rotundity as Lula herself. It was constantly in the back of her mind and frequently in a front pew. She liked to discuss it with her friends and her husband—complainingly, anxiously, plaintively, contemplatively, suggestively and in various other ways. Jake listened and grunted; sometimes he forgot to listen and grunt while his mind was dwelling on the quantity of sugar, or molasses, or something else needed in the store. She occasionally noted this lack of attention on Jake's part but did not really resent it, for, she thought; if he doesn't pay much attention to it he probably still likes me all right. But if he should notice much, or if it should increase, I must certainly do something. But this something, what should it be? What

method must be adopted? She consulted the doctor on his next visit. That much harassed and suffering servant of humanity suggested more exercise and careful avoidance of fat and sugar in the diet. He also suggested that it would be well to eat very sparingly and always leave the table hungry. This gave her something to do, and she straightway began a course of sprouts with herself. It was a sore trial to eat too little, but she did it. Was it not worth something to retain Jake's admiration and desolation to lose it?

This whole matter was duly discussed and thoroughly considered, forwards, backwards and sideways, when she and Nan next met. After which Nan trotted out *her* trouble. It was necessary, she said, that she should gain weight. Tom had commented on her slimness, compared her to a rail and several other articles more noted for length than breadth. Nan only weighed 115. She should weigh at least 140. How could she increase her weight? Lula had been reading up about such matters in a book recommended by Dr. Dash, and she would see what he said and report.

This was done and Nan was recommended to eat plenty of raw eggs every day. A dozen a day would not be too many. If she could not afford so many eat as many as she thought she could afford; and drink lots of milk. If this would not make her fat nothing would. It was necessary, too, to take lots of exercise. The doctors say that exercise is necessary to health, and whether you are to get thin or fat exercise is of first importance.

After two weeks of self denial and exercise to excess, as she thought, Lula, who had weighed 160, found her net reduced to 155. This seemed to her hard lines. The game was not worth the candle. But she persevered and at the end of two weeks more had fallen to 150. This was encouraging, but she began to fear she would not be able to hold out forever. She was so desperately hungry! Her dreams began to be haunted by luscious feasts. She woke up in the night, ravenous. She told Jake that if she were not desperately fond of him she would bite him. At this, Jake only grunted. The worst deprivation was candy. She was extravagantly fond of it, but the doctor sternly forbade it. Candy, fat and sugar, as well as starchy foods were to be eschewed; even potatoes were forbidden.

Nan, on the contrary, had eaten raw eggs and milk until she gagged every time she undertook to eat a raw egg in milk. Lula suggested using a little brandy to give a flavor, but this soon palled. She did manage to reach 118

but halted there. Lula halted, too, on the downward path, at 150. No amount of fasting or exercise seemed to avail. About this time she discovered that her skin was getting wrinkled and that, worst of all, wrinkles were forming on her face. After much consultation it was decided that a visit to a beauty doctor might possibly remedy this. Instead of one visit several were required. All this time her appetite was growing mightier and mightier. Finally she fell. They had been shopping together. She had seen candy displayed until she was reckless. In this mood, after leaving Nan, she hurried into a candy shop with the air of a criminal, bought and ate half a pound. Nothing serious happened immediately, so in a few days she bought and ate again—clandestinely. Made reckless by lack of immediate results she resumed her old habits and presently found her weight increasing rapidly—more rapidly than it had gone down.

Nan had become discouraged. She felt well—better than she had felt for a long time. She had, in fact, before this been eating too little. Too many meals had been passed with nothing eaten but tea and toast—now she was really nourished for the first time in years.

About this time she heard some one remark that yeast was a very fattening food, and that she herself had put on twenty pounds by eating a cake daily for three months. So Nan bought a cake and ate it with many qualms. It was certainly not very agreeable to the taste. She persevered, however, and after two weeks discovered that she was indeed gaining. In fact she began to get fat. Slowly but steadily she put on weight until she became alarmed. She was obliged to buy an entire new outfit and although she stopped the yeast cakes she still swelled. Now in despair she began, like Lula, to diet.

But imagine if you can all the discussions, the visits to and fro, the consultations without end to which these fluctuations led. In mercy I have not recounted them—but they took place.

Lula did her own washing, rolled on the floor every morning, practised calisthenics. Wonderful to relate, she began to lose flesh steadily; her skin wrinkled and her color faded. She became alarmed and consulted the doctor who failed to find anything wrong. Now Lula is desperately trying to lay on flesh while Nan is just as determinedly reducing.

“I never realized before,” said Lewellyn, “what an awful thing it must be to be a woman.”

“It is indeed piteous,” said Sam. “The poor things have to wear skirts; they are not allowed to put their feet on the table or spit tobacco juice on the stove. But then they are freely allowed to do the washing and such light work as taking care of ten or twelve children.”

“You must remember the disabilities she suffers,” said Fred. “She is not allowed to go to war, nor is she expected to haul out manure in the hot weather. When the time comes for putting in wheat I know of nothing more enjoyable than hauling out manure and spreading it on the field. The smell is appetizing, and like most perfume, it clings. The flies are active and make the horses playful. I seldom enjoy life so much as then; and it worries me that the dear ladies are not privileged to participate.”

“Sam is right,” said Anita, “The women are privileged to bring up the children. They bear the brunt of their childish impatience, recklessness and disobedience. They stay up with them nights when they are sick and they are expected to be patient and long suffering with husbands and children when they can scarcely drag one foot after the other. I *have* known of cases,” she continued, “where the women hauled coal out of the cellars habitually, and cases are known where women plow, haul manure, clean out dirty stables and help in the field. I don’t really think the women need complain that their work is lacking either in quality, quantity or variety.”

Woozy

Woozy opened his eyes for the first time and looked up. There was a little boy, and in his hand was a saucer in which was some white stuff. The boy smiled at him. Woozy was interested in the white stuff; it looked good. He licked some with his tongue. It tasted good but it was very cold. Woozy licked it again but pretty soon his tongue got so cold he would have to stop licking for awhile. But he went on licking and after awhile it was all gone and the dish was licked clean. Then he looked up at the boy and said: “Woof!” But it was a very small woof, for Woozy was a very small, round, roly poly puppy. He said woof, three or four times but the boy only smiled for he had no more of the white stuff. He would have given more to Woozy if he had had it but he could not give more if he did not have it.

Pretty soon the door opened and a monstrous big dog came in. She went over and tried to lick the boy’s face. Then she laid down beside him. Then the boy took a ball of cord and rolled it into a corner and Woozy trotted after it. He grabbed it and worried it, and growled—frightfully. Pretty soon his mother went over to him, took him by the back of the neck and carried him over to the boy and laid him down, as much as to say:

“I think he is naughty, and you had better make him behave.” But the boy just smiled and stroked the dogs with his hand. First he would stroke the mother and then he would stroke Woozy. The mother would lick his hand but Woozy pinched it with his sharp little teeth.

Woozy and the boy grew up together. They both got bigger every day until the boy was nearly as big as his father and Woozy nearly as big as his mother. Woozy thought the boy was perfect. He followed him everywhere. If you saw the boy anywhere you might know that Woozy was around, and if you saw Woozy you might know that the boy was not far off.

Sometimes they took long walks together in the woods. Woozy would run off among the trees but pretty soon he would come back to the boy and look up in his face and say: “woof,” which meant why don’t you come along and have some fun? Once robbers tried to steal the boy, but Woozy growled and showed his teeth until the robbers ran away.

One day the boy was crossing a pasture field. There was a cross bull there lying down behind some bushes. When he saw the boy he began pawing the dirt and then he ran after him. Woozy grabbed the bull’s tail and held on till the bull turned around. Then he fell off and rolled over and over. The bull ran after him and stuck one horn through his poor body. The boy had climbed over the fence and he screamed and cried with all his might. Then the bull threw up his head and poor Woozy’s dead body flew over the fence. Oh, how mad the boy was and how he cried! His mamma said, “Never mind dear, Woozy was willing to give his life for you.” But the boy was lonely, and he cried as hard as he could cry when they buried Woozy in the garden.

The Hermit

In a cave on the south side of the mountain there once lived a hermit. He was only middle aged but his hair was white. He was kind of manner and speech but he often sighed as one bereft of hope. He worked for the farmers round about, who paid him with potatoes or other produce or sometimes with money when they could spare it. He lived a lonely life on the mountainside with no one to share it. Here he snared rabbits and caught skunks and foxes and sold their skins. In a space before the cave he built a rough cabin which concealed the entrance. To one side of this he built a shack to house his chickens and on the other side he planted apples, pears and peaches. Grapes he shunned as open to misconception. He gathered firewood in the forest and no one molested him. The water for drinking and cooking came from a spring on the mountainside not far from his door.

He was kind to the children and often gave them candy. The path to and from the schoolhouse led past his door and he often saw the school teacher passing. She was a lady who had begun to teach several years before this story opens. She had been very beautiful as a girl but now some of her fresh complexion had gone where the good complexions go, and she was using a powder puff instead. Her nose was a little sharper and she was rather more positive in some of her ideas than she had been as a young girl. The children always spoke to the hermit and in this way she got to know him.

At Christmas time she had a two-weeks vacation. There was a heavy fall of snow which drifted, so that all the roads were closed. She said to her mother:

“I wonder how my poor hermit is getting along in this snow, all alone on the mountainside.”

“It is too bad,” said her mother, who did and said pretty much as Anna-Bell wished her.

When school opened again she stopped at his house to enquire.

The hermit said he was getting along pretty well, thank you, but she looked around the room with distaste. There was much dirt in the corners, the windows needed cleaning and dirty dishes were standing on the table.

“Don’t you ever go to town?” said she.

“Yes,” he replied, “I am going this afternoon and shall not get home until after dark.”

She made no reply but a light came into her eyes. After school she hurried to the cottage, pinned a towel around her and began to sweep and scrub. Then she closed the door carefully and went home. When he came home it seemed more cheerful but he noticed nothing more. The next morning he only said: “Good Morning,” though she seemed to expect something more. That afternoon on her way home she asked him for a drink of water.

Then she said to him: “Where are you from?”

“My home was in New York,” said he.

“What did you do?” she asked.

“I was in the commission business,” he replied, “but I grew ashamed.”

“You deserve a reward,” said she, “choose one!”

“I need a cook,” said he, “come and cook for me as soon as you can learn.”

Sandy's Story

I used to live in New Jersey when I was young, in a place called Lopatcong Mills. I was workin in the mills. There was two other fellers workin there with me and we was about the same age, size and build, as you might say.

One of the fellers was Sam Harkness and the other Enos Kerber. Enos was all for gittin married. He was e'enamost crazy about gals, and I guess he pestered 'em some. Anyhow he didn't seem to get along very fast gittin married.

I aint very keen about gals myself, and I wasn't then; but, as I said, Enos liked to be with 'em. He spent most all his wages buyin ice cream fer 'em. He said he kinda liked to see 'em lickin it up like nice little pussy cats.

"Yes," I says, "I guess you would like to be a mouse," says I, "and listen to what they says."

"No," says he, "but they use me like the cat would a mouse."

Well, he was always talkin about the gals and about gittin married 'till I got e'enamost worn out. So one day I says: "Enos," says I, "why don't you advertise?"

"Advertise fer what?" says he.

"Why, fer a wife," says I.

"Sure," says he, "where can I do it?"

Sam Harkness and me put our heads together, as you might say, and we wrote an “ad” like this:

“Advertiser wants to marry nice-looking girl about 20. Address with photo, Box 28, Phillipsburg, N. J.”

We sent this with \$5.00 to a paper in Chicago that we had seen, and pretty soon Enos began to git letters and photos. The photos was all good lookin; and to some of the best lookers Enos sent hisn. Now, hisn was what you might call a side face, kinda sickly smilin, as if the man that took it had said: “Now look smilin!”

Enos wasn’t a bad looker, himself, nor he wasn’t no beauty neither.

One day I took the bosses wife to the train; and I was standin on the platform, when a middle aged female comes up to me and flung her arms around me.

“Hello! Sandy,” says she, “here I am. Aint ye glad? Why,” she says, “you’re better lookin than yer picture. I just took *such* a fancy to it that I got right on the train and come right on, and here I am.”

“Who are you lookin fer?” says I, gittin flustered, “I don’t know nothing about this. What do you mean, anyhow?”

“Young man,” says she, “is this you? and is this your handwritin?” so sayin, she pulls out a picture of me and a letter which I had written fer Enos in lead pencil; but his name was rubbed out and mine signed.

“Well, that’s my picture,” says I, “but that letter’s a forgery, as you might say.”

Well, she bust out a cryin and a crowd begun to form, so I put her in the wagon and took her to the mill fer dinner. Then I brought her back and put her on the train, her crying most of the time. I paid her fare both ways and she said I was real kind and must come to see her, but I aint been yet.

The Hoboes

After the close of the Civil War, from 1865 to a much later date, a great many men had been soldiers and were discharged, had grown fond of a wandering life and were unable to resist its charms. It was about this time that the army of tramps gained so many recruits as to become a great national nuisance. Many of these men were still clad, in whole or in part, in army blue uniforms; and some of the army overcoats survived several winters. There were many of these hoboes on the road, moving from place to place, sometimes afoot, sometimes beating their way on the railroads, where they finally became a menace to the trainmen and to the communities along the right of way.

Most of the subsistence of these tramps was lifted from the charitable by the process known as “slamming gates.” Not a few of the tramps were very soft spoken when men or cross dogs were about but became bold and saucy when the women folks were alone. The food gained by begging was supplemented by petty thefts of chickens, eggs, green corn and other produce and the snaring of rabbits and other small game.

Just above Milford, New Jersey, the Delaware River breaks through a ridge of New Red Sandstone, forming a cliff of red rock, the color of which is due to peroxid of iron, facing the south. Along these cliffs there are many ledges; and in the winter, as the sun beats against these ledges, it heats the rocks and creates an atmosphere several degrees warmer than that of the surrounding country.

On one of these ledges overhanging the railroad, which follows the New Jersey shore of the river, a band of hoboes had established their camp. There had been a heavy fall of snow the night before as two tramps were released from the county prison at Flemington where they had been spending a sad week breaking stone.

“Better not come this way again,” said the Sheriff as he released them; “we’ve got your numbers here, and next time you’ll get a heavy dose.”

“I’m going to head for Milford camp,” said Harvard Jim to Deadwood Ike, his companion, “I am getting tired of Jersey.”

“This here beats cock fightin,” replied Ike. “Every darn muscle in my body aches to beat the band, and here we’re turned out in the snow. Lucky we had breakfast.”

All day they plodded doggedly along toward Milford, cold and with wet feet. At noon they had several “hand outs” which fended off starvation, and that night they camped in a wood where the bushes sheltered them and their fire. The next day was warmer and the sun shone, melting the snow. They reached the camp with wet feet, tired and hungry and were greeted with jeers and laughter. The pot was boiling over a wood fire and they were soon fed and warmed. The ground was bare and not too dry as they hunted a place to rest. Finally, Ike curled down and tried to go to sleep, but was kept awake by an intolerable prickling sensation in his back. This grew worse until it became intolerable.

“Say boys!” said he, “Something’s the matter with my back.” So saying, he started to strip off his coat.

“Wait a minute,” said Harvard Jim, “you have something hanging to your coat.” So saying, he pulled it off but immediately began to dance and swear.

“That’s a cactus,” said another tramp. “I forgot to tell you they’re thick around here.”

The best part of an hour was spent in picking spines from their respective hides, and then they once more went to rest, this time carefully inspecting the premises to avoid the cactus.

Next morning they started for the Milford Bridge resolved to quit Jersey forever; but at the bridge they were met by the toll-keeper who declined to

allow them to pass without the customary two cents each. This they did not have but were forced to beg with poor success—plenty to eat but no money. Just at this point they were stopped by the constable who put them under arrest for begging.

“Say, friend,” said Harvard Jim, “if you will find us a place where we can saw some wood for a quarter we will pay our way over the bridge and stay away from Jersey.”

“All right,” said the constable, “I have some wood myself.”

For two hours they toiled, one with the saw, the other with the axe, sawing and splitting a huge pile of firewood, inspected meanwhile by the constable. At the end of this time they struck work and were offered ten cents each.

“Have a heart, brother,” said Ike, “that’s no way to treat us.”

“Beat it, or I’ll put you in the jug,” said he, “and none of your lip, either.”

They were silent until they reached the middle of the bridge; then Ike shook his fist at Jersey and swore furiously.

“Breakin stone, trampin in snow, sleepin on cactus, sawin wood, an cheatin constables. Damn such a State!”

Jumping Steel

“I suppose you know,” said Sam “that there are a great many kinds of steel in the market nowadays, such as high carbon steel, low carbon steel, manganese steel, tungsten steel, nickel steel....”

“Yes,” said Lewellyn, “and Wildcat oil steal and Wall Street steals....”

“Now, Lewellyn,” said aunt Margaret, “this is Sam’s story, not yours.”

“All right,” said Lewellyn, “I guess I can stand it if you can.”

“There are a great many ways of treating steel, too,” continued Sam, “for giving it desired properties, some of which have been very successful.”

“I knew a fellow in the Bethlehem Steel Company several years ago who was a nut on steel treating. He said that by selecting the proper kind of steel, such as nickel steel or chrome steel or some other sort, it was possible to get any desired properties if you gave the steel proper heat treatment. He was my roommate for a year and he talked about this so much that I got all worn out—and mad.

“First I told him that I wanted a steal that could not be found out but he paid no attention. Then I asked whether it would be possible to make a steel for springs that could be pushed down two inches and come back four. I found I had given him something to think about. He shut up right away and began to think. I could always tell when he was thinking by the fishy stare that came into his eye; like the eye of a fresh fish that is ten days old.

“He studied on this for nearly a week and I had a blessed rest. I began to hope it would keep him quiet forever; but at the end of the week he said he thought he could do it. His eyes had lost the fishy stare and a smile spread over his face and stayed there. I forget what the steel was to have in it but I remember it was to contain molybdenum.

“He went up to Bethlehem the very next day and I saw no more of him for a week. When he came back he said he had been working hard and thought he was on the track but the darn stuff was brittle. Still he thought he might be able to overcome that if he had time enough. I told him he could have all the time that was coming but he paid no attention. Every time he came back after that he would sit and stare and the fishy look would come back: then he would slap his leg and hurry back to Bethlehem.

“About a month after I had put the idea into his head he came back one day and said he had the kind of steel I wanted.

“I told him to make me two coiled springs two inches wide and four inches long, with a steel plate fastened to either end. One of these plates was to have four holes in for screws, so it could be fastened to the heel of a shoe. I said that on second thought he had better make three springs, so that if one broke we might still have enough.

“Yes, he thought that might be wise, because springs were apt to break. When he came back next time he had a dozen springs in a box. They were beautifully made and were silver plated, too.

“Then we couldn’t agree at first who should put them on and see how they worked. He said I had started the idea, and it would not be fair that he should have the honor of first trying them. But I said the idea was not worth much; he had made the right kind of steel and the way to heat treat it; that was two to my one. I was really afraid to try the darn things myself, and when you hear what happened you won’t wonder.

“We fastened one spring to each of a pair of his shoes. He did not put them on but carried them and wore another pair to the end of Bushkill Street where we planned to try them out. There isn’t much traffic there, and we wanted a quiet place for our experiment. He put on the spring shoes at Green Street and jumped towards the river. The first jump was two feet, the second four, the third eight and the fourth sixteen. By the time he got to the

river he was jumping sixty-four feet at a clip. Then the spring on his left foot broke with a loud crack and he turned half around and struck the water horizontally at thirty miles an hour. He went under and came up a little further on, came around in a circle and shot out on the sand. He was stunned at first, but as soon as he felt a little better he asked me to get his other shoes and take these off, which I did.

“After that we walked home and he sat thinking for quite awhile. After he came out of this trance he said it seemed easy enough to go, the problem was, how were we to stop? He thought it would be easy to steer, too, by holding one foot out a little further than the other. We could learn to do that easy enough. The best way to stop, he thought, would be to have a spring on the end of a stick. By holding this so it would strike the ground first it would send you back and then you would stop.

“So he got a stick, or rather two sticks—one for each hand—and put a spring on each. We had our next jumpin match on the Twelfth Street lot about midnight of a moonlight night. He jumped two feet and came back four; jumped eight feet and came back sixteen. By the time he was up to sixty-four feet he struck the roof of a house, went through and landed in a bed. It was lucky he did: he might have been killed if he had landed anywhere else. It was a slate roof, and he was pretty badly scratched when he came down in his stocking feet. He was afraid to keep his shoes on for fear he might get started again. The man who owned the house was with him, looking pretty mad.

“It cost him quite a little to mend the roof and pacify the man, but he finally got it fixed up. I told him he wanted to be more careful; next time he might land in a bed with some girl or the old woman and that would cost him more yet.

“I got so nervous about this time that I moved into another room. I was afraid if I went on going out with him the police might manage to stay awake long enough to pinch us. The last time I saw him he told me they had made some bed springs out of this steel by mistake and some of them were sent out and used. He heard of a man who had a cot in his summer tent. He came in one afternoon very tired and threw himself on the cot and the next thing he knew he flew through the top of the tent fell back and broke

through and landed on the floor with an awful jolt. He told me he was sure that steel would be a money maker as soon as he learned how to control it.”

All the Way from Melbourne

A college teacher learns much about far away places if he cares to do so. This knowledge is also very intimate and very accurate. It is the kind of knowledge that cannot be drawn from books of travel or from encyclopedias. It is first-hand information given by people who have lived there. It is obtained from his students. Most of those he is called upon to teach come, probably, from within a radius of fifty or a hundred miles. There is always a sprinkling, however, of boys from far off places.

Rochambeau College always has a few such. I can remember among them several from Japan, from China, India, South America, and one from Siam. We sometimes hear from these boys after they have returned to their homes and once in a great while we are rich enough to visit them. What a fuss they make when we do and how glad they seem to be to see us. I have been something of a traveler in a small way and everywhere I have gone, and been able to turn aside to visit the boys, I have met the most cordial welcome. This is one of the rewards that come to the teacher who has tried to do his best. Sometimes he comes in contact with people from distant lands in strange ways; and it is about one of these strange happenings that I am about to tell.

After I had been teaching for several years I married Sally Lunn, the daughter of a local baker. We had two sons and a daughter to bless our union. I noticed as the years passed that my surplus cash was waning rather than waxing. This led me to make a careful review of the situation. My salary was scarcely opulent and was not mounting with great rapidity. It

was evident that if Providence saw fit to endow us with a continued shower of childish blessings I must either find more income or breakfast, lunch and dine on corn mush—and I was not fond of mush.

Among my early investments had been the purchase of a printing press. The outfit was a small one but it was complete and such as enabled me to make a beginning as a printer in a small way. As I practised the art I became constantly more skilful and could now print a very fair job. This seemed to furnish an opening and I went to work. The venture was moderately successful and led to a decided, though moderate, increase in my income. Presently I was able to buy a larger press and more type and to rent a room in the town in which to install it. Here I employed a competent foreman and began my commercial career.

I had written a text book for my pupils in the meantime and this I printed and published. Then I started a journal in which my book was advertised, leading to orders from abroad and the influx of manuscripts from my friends. In a few years I had a prosperous business on my hands and all my spare time was usefully employed. It soon became necessary to arrange for agents for the sale of my publications abroad. This was easily arranged in London and Tokio but more difficult in other places. I wrote to Secretary of Commerce Hoover for the name of an agent in Melbourne and he sent me the names of about fifty firms, dealers in books in that place. I immediately aimed at the flock and fired four letters at random, but brought down no birds. Weeks and months passed on without a response.

I am a late riser by preference and an early one only under compulsion. I was finishing my breakfast at a moderate rate one morning when word came that a gentleman had called and was waiting for me. My visitor was a middle aged man, plainly dressed in tweed with a cloth cap. He informed me that he was traveling for pleasure and had undertaken to go from New York to San Francisco by auto. He had stopped for the night at our local hotel and in descending a dark stairway had fallen and broken his arm. He was admitted to the hospital, permitted the setting of the arm and submitted to the necessary delay—for it was impossible to drive with one arm. He found himself doomed to inaction, for his daily occupation was confined to a visit to the hospital to have his arm dressed, and time hung heavy on his hands. In this dilemma he inquired of Dr. Kuhlmann, his attendant and one

of my old students, whether there was not some one else in the place with a taste for science. Dr. Kuhlmann had referred him to me.

I told Mr. Humphreys that I was very glad to meet him and would do my best to help him pass the time pleasantly during his enforced delay. I found he was posted on his own country, Australia. He knew something about its geology and about its politics also. I announced that we would have an evening together with our professors of geology and economics in a day or two, as soon as it could be arranged. In the meantime I asked him whether he liked to dance? He said he did, and my wife, who had met him by this time, invited him to spend that very evening with us—we expected some young people in to dance and thought it might amuse him. He came and was much liked by the young folks. A few evenings later he came to tea with us and spent the evening with the two professors and their wives. Of course they pumped him for first-hand information and obtained it. We spent a delightful and very profitable evening together.

The next morning I proposed to take him over my publishing house. We met there and made the rounds. I showed him some of our books and he appeared to be more than ordinarily interested in them. As he was leaving he informed me that he was starting for the West in the morning after. “I don’t see why,” he said, “I might not sell some of your books myself. I am a scientific bookseller in Melbourne, and I shall take great pleasure in selling as many of your books as I can.”

A Defense of the Wealthy

Contrary to a generally held opinion, there are some wealthy people who may be successfully defended. There are not so many of them, however, that any serious disturbance need be created. There is, perhaps, some danger that these may be overlooked in the universal damnation that is being handed out to the malefactors of great wealth.

The first exception to be noted is that of the inventor. Quite a few of these men have lightened our tasks to a very considerable extent. They have in a few cases amassed a competence by taxing us for their inventions for seventeen years. After that their work is free for all, at least in theory. A great many of these men have had no benefit from their inventions and might well be pensioned from public funds. In not a few cases the profits that should have gone to them have been filched by men who had money to lend. Such cases should be overhauled and the ill-gotten gains of the banker folks restored to their proper owners. It would be well also to give the bankers the spanking they need, thus making one job of the whole business.

When we think that Whitney, who invented the cotton gin; Steinmetz, the electrical wizard; Pupin, who perfected the telephone; Edison, Gray, Acheson, Morse, McCormick and thousands of others, some as well, others less well known belong to this class, we realize how greatly we are indebted to them, and how cheaply we get off by allowing them to profit by their inventions for seventeen short years.

Then there are some school teachers and college professors who might be excepted and a few ministers. Some of these fellows married money, and we will not except these; some of them inherited money, and we will not except these; a few of them stole money, and these must be spanked. After these exceptions have been made there will be a few left and they have lived such a deuce of a life that we will let them go.

There does not seem to be any great harm in the man who saved in order that he might keep out of the almshouse when he grew too old to work. We should not tax these people, either, if they have only moderate means. Our wise legislators, however, do not seem to think so. Many cases of this kind have been heard of during and since the late unpleasantness where the poor souls had a hard time keeping body and spirit together after the tax collector was through with them.

All farmers who have made money should be let off, provided they made money by real farming and not by selling fancy cattle, poultry, etc., at startling prices. Real farming is a man's job, and those who succeed at it deserve to be patted on the back. The fellows who sell the blooded stock belong in about the same class as the bond salesman—we will come to these later on.

The married couples who bring up and properly educate, say four or more children, are also deserving. If their children are grateful so much the better; if they chip in and support their father and mother—fine! In the last case we might safely except everybody concerned.

Of course we must except the lame, the halt and the blind; and perhaps a few others have been unintentionally skipped, but there seem to be few others. Now we come to those who need punishment of some kind.

First among these are the office-holders. There are a few among them who really earn all they get—but not many. Office holding ought to be made a dangerous business, and running for the Presidency punished with death.

Bankers ought to be periodically inspected and made to give an account of themselves, so should lawyers, and real-estate agents. The doctors, some of them, need watching. They are a frightfully jealous lot and outside testimony only, can be relied on. If a good one is found he should be patted on the back. There are a lot of these but most of them live in the country

where the air is good. Those who live in the city and have hospitals where they charge \$100.00 for opening a pimple and \$25.00 for giving you four ounces of ether should be heavily docked and then fined.

There are far too many wholesale and retail merchants and too few farmers. We might well cut out half of the merchants for a start and make them move out on farms where they could be really useful. If they commit suicide instead of farming, so much the better. There are also too many book agents and bond salesmen and brokers and clerks in stores. Too many newspapers are published and too much paper wasted in doing it. This needs regulating. The best way to do it is to tax these things and let the farmers alone for the present, until they have \$5.00 ahead.

And the fellows who are loafing around waiting for a bonus should be put to a painless death. They will never be of any real use. The labor agitators and strike leaders are in the way, too.

Anybody who spends his time loafing or playing golf should be stopped, questioned and put to work. If he refuses he should be shipped off to an island set apart for the purpose where he must work or starve.

All such wealthy ones should be treated as indicated and some of those not wealthy but who belong to the same classes need much the same treatment.

While we are about it we may perhaps just as well do a little more regulating. The Germans, for example, have too many children and the French too few. We should take warning and govern ourselves accordingly. Of course some people claim that these things are regulated by Providence but it seems probable that there are other forces at work. Four children to a family seems to be about right and it is suggested that a committee, all the members of which have done their full duty and are from Missouri, be appointed to see that there are no slackers. This is a species of wealth that needs regulating as well as other kinds.

The old maids and old bachelors should be heavily taxed unless they can satisfy a Missouri committee that they have made determined efforts to commit matrimony. In that case they should have assistance.

All would-be voters should be carefully examined before it is allowed and the recall and repeal should be in order. Every voter should be able to spell his or her name, tell what rivers run through and by Easton, where the

Atlantic is situated and what Sing Sing is noted for. After all are educated up to this point, the tests should gradually be toughened until only those really fit can vote. They should be *made* to vote every time. Gradually, in this way, every man can learn how to milk cows, husk corn, run a plow and chase the pigs out of the oats. The women will be able to darn stockings, bake bread, sew shirts and run a bridge party.

By the time these ideas are put to work the millennium will be close at hand and we need no longer flee from the tax gatherer or hide from the bond salesman.

The Skin of the Bear

This story, according to De Comines, was told by the Emperor Frederick III of Germany to an emissary of King Louis XI of France who wished him to conspire against the Duke of Burgundy to their mutual advantage:

Two ne'er-do-wells living in the interior of Germany had patronized the local inn keeper without paying his bill until the latter became weary. He finally told them that he would give them no more credit. They soon became hungry, thirsty and desperate, and consulted together as to how they might once more establish their credit. While engaged in thus scheming their hunger and thirst steadily increased until it became overpowering. Now you must know that the villagers had been greatly harried by a monstrous big black bear who, from the adjoining forest, ravaged their flocks and their gardens. He was especially fond of sheep and almost nightly carried off and devoured them. Nothing was any longer safe in the village night or day and large rewards were offered to anyone who would kill him and thus save them from loss. This was known to the two bums who proceeded to make use of it with the good natured landlord. They told him if he would only give them enough to eat and drink to appease their hunger and thirst they would at once go in search of the bear and proceed to kill him and take off his hide. This, they assured the inn keeper, was an enormous hide and its sale would yield a large sum which they proposed to use in extinguishing their debt and any future advances he might see fit to make. This was not all; with the rewards they would collect they should become opulent, and they promised to spend this at his house, so that all

this money would in the long run come to him alone. The tavern keeper was of an optimistic turn of mind and listened to their tale with renewed hope, finally agreeing to do as they asked. The two conspirators, as soon as they had filled their bellies started out in quest of the bear. Now it happened that bruin had become hungry earlier than usual that evening and that he had started to forage earlier. After eating several ears of corn which he took from a field alongside the road he hurried along in the gathering dusk toward the village. The adventurers were headed in the opposite direction on the same road and they rapidly drew together. The bear was the first to detect their approach with a loud Whoof! This startled the bums and frightened them very badly. Without the least delay, the eldest promptly took to a tree which, fortunately for him, spread its branches close by the road. The second loafer was so badly frightened that he fell down in a dead faint and lay upon the ground without motion. Without hesitating the bear trotted up and smelled the man by putting his nose to the latter's ear. Finding no motion, and thinking the man dead, the bear, after taking several sniffs and turning the fellow over with a thrust of its paw, proceeded on its way. After a short time the tree climber descended and ran off as fast as his legs could carry him. The man who had fainted presently recovered and proceeded to do likewise. Seeing his friend scampering along at a great pace some distance ahead he hailed him and his friend stopped and allowed him to come up. Together they proceeded toward the town and related their tale to the landlord, not without much embellishment. The tavern keeper finally agreed, in consideration of the difficulty of their task, to give a further extension of credit. But the tree climber was dissatisfied and proceeded to question his fellow bum. "What did the bear ask you," said he, "when he whispered in your ear?" His mate replied: "He did not whisper to me."

"Yes he did," said the first, "he whispered in your ear for some time. Did I not see him do it? Try not to deceive me, it will be in vain."

Now the faint-hearted one was also a wit and he, therefore, hesitated and finally confessed that something had passed, but declared he was not obliged to divulge it. This made the first bum angry and he assailed his fellow with threats and reproaches. But still the latter declined to divulge the secret. This led to renewed threats and finally to blows. The possessor of the secret was vanquished and finally agreed to tell it to his fellow, but

only in the presence of the landlord and the village magistrate. It was also agreed that after telling the secret he should be allowed to go free without further molestation. To this clause the landlord, whose curiosity had been aroused, also agreed; further, he promised to protect the possessor of the secret. These details having been arranged the parties met one morning in the house of the magistrate. The second vagabond first recited the agreement and having procured the assent of all parties began as follows:

“When Bruin appeared I was frightened and fell in a faint. From this I was awakened by a rough tongue licking my cheek and a bearish voice whispering in my ear. It said: ‘You were to kill me were you not, and to take off my hide and sell it? And you were to collect the money offered as rewards, and having thus acquired much money you agreed, did you not, to pay the account of the landlord and stay with him until your money was exhausted?’

“I was badly frightened and, thinking my time had come and resolving to endanger my hope of salvation by no more lies, I nodded my head in assent. The bear then said:

“‘Very well, you are properly punished. As for the rascal in the tree the inn keeper has made no agreement with him such as that he will make with you; and when you have escaped his wrath I advise him to clap him in jail. In the meantime I will advise you both never in future to sell the hide of a bear before you have killed it, nor would I collect rewards for its death before the death takes place.’ As for the Judge, he is a rascal anyhow and at all times, and is well able to take care of himself.” With this the vagabond darted from the room and ran up the street pursued by all three who had forgotten their promises in their resentment. He however made good his escape.

A Visit from the Wileys

Many years ago, shortly after I began teaching at Lafayette College, I determined to join The American Association for the Advancement of Science. This long-winded name was given by themselves to a collection of bookworms who every year assembled in some good-sized city, after having collected some thousands of dollars for expenses of the local merchants, and held as many as a dozen pow wows in as many different rooms. In one of these rooms a learned discussion on one or more mathematical questions was kept up during most of the hours of daylight; in a second, subjects in physics were undergoing examination; a third room was occupied by the chemists, a fourth by the biologists; everywhere there was a sprinkling of “nuts” who were in danger of breaking out and must be sat upon in order not to discredit the serious minded.

The discussions sometimes dropped into a burst of self-admiration by some savant devoted to the holy cause of science who was keeping the lamp of knowledge burning in poverty and distress. These wails were occasionally broken in upon by another wholesome-minded soul, like the great Cope, who boldly declared that he was not suffering but having a good time and could be happy in no other way.

In the evenings some of us put on our best clothes and attended a garden party given by a local magnate where we met the money bags of the neighborhood and for an hour breathed the unaccustomed air of luxury; or we attended an evening lecture given by some member of the attending band of scientists in compliment to the hosts; a chosen few assembled at a

room where good beer was to be had, in ordinary dress, drank a little beer and listened to stories and discussions straight from the shoulder and worth while.

It was in these evening discussions and in daylight visits to points of geological or other interest that we became acquainted and learned to enjoy the great week of the year. It was here that I first met Le Conte, Cope, Major Powell, the one-armed explorer of the Colorado canyon, Brashear, who made his first lenses from tumbler bottoms and Wiley, the jolly farmer giant, *facile princeps* among men.

I believe I first met Wiley at Buffalo in August, 1886. We visited Niagara together as part of a jolly crowd and had a happy day. Nearly every year for many years after I met Wiley at these meetings. I also met him elsewhere. He came to Easton nearly every year for awhile to lecture to my students. The lecture room was large enough to hold the audience at first, but as he became better known we moved over to Pardee Hall into a room large enough to hold the crowd that came to enjoy the treat. Presently the "old man," as we called him, was asked to go to Lehigh whenever he came to Lafayette. I always went up with him and listened again. His lectures were always new, never twice the same.

On one occasion he wrote me asking whether he might spend an extra day with me and I gladly acceded. We rode all day through the hills and woods over Scott's Mountain and had a jolly day. When the attempt to pass pure food legislation became strenuous Frear and I conspired in its behalf and carried our point. When he became President of the American Chemical Society he chose me as editor and we toiled together at the heavy task. Afterwards I printed and published his great work on Agricultural Chemical Analysis. In all this work and play he was the kind, indulgent older brother.

For many years he led the lonely imperfect life of a bachelor until he had reached the ripe age of 62 when his love of many years yielded to his wishes and they were married. I shall never forget the glad smile on his face as my wife and I came up to congratulate them and he realized that we had traveled all the way from Easton to wish him joy.

Upon a later occasion we visited Washington with a large party of chemists and, with many others were the guests of Dr. and Mrs. Wiley at a dinner at the Raleigh. But we had the advantage of most of the other guests, for we

were admitted behind the scenes before the dinner came off. Mrs. Wiley and Nan Pierce, Dr. Wiley's Secretary, told us about some of the funny things that had occurred. Dr. Wiley was away from home and they were forced to make all the arrangements. They knew only a few of his friends and succeeded in inviting several dead people to the feast.

Upon another occasion we were in Washington with a party of Rotarians and the Wileys invited us to dinner at their home in Ashmead Place. Here we met the Wiley boys, Harvey Jr. and John, for the first time, while my wife told us, to our great joy, how, by a series of amusing misunderstandings, she had narrowly escaped being a guest at one of Mrs. Harding's private parties. In the evening we attended a literary soiree with Dr. and Mrs. Wiley and greatly enjoyed the papers read and the chaff that formed a part. It was a real literary treat.

Then we learned that his eyesight was failing and that he was soon to be operated upon for cataract. The day of the operation passed and we had no news. We dare not telegraph for fear the operation had not succeeded. Thus a week passed. At last we learned that he saw once more though not so well as of old.

We saw Dr. Wiley again at the Golden Wedding of Dr. and Mrs. W. H. Nichols at Sherry's last winter. Dr. Wiley seemed well and in good spirits. We saw comparatively little of him here because so many of his friends were present and each claimed a share of his time.

Several months later a letter arrived telling us that the family expected to start for Cambridge, Mass., shortly, where Wiley was to attend the fiftieth reunion of his class at Harvard. They would arrive in Easton in the evening by auto and would spend the night with us. I immediately replied that the road up College Hill was closed for repairs and that they must telephone me on arrival and allow me to join and pilot them.

Accordingly, at 8 P. M. the telephone rang and Mrs. Wiley's voice announced their arrival. They were dusty and tired and soon after dinner retired to rest.

We have quite a good-sized house but the family is large and only two extra rooms were available. One of these contained a large wooden bedstead heavy and strong enough to support a hippopotamus; this was dedicated to

Dr. and Mrs. Wiley. The other room had a large brass bedstead which had been used for many years. Originally it had been well and strong; but long continued use by our four stocky boys as a spring-board and general exercise ground had weakened our confidence in its ability to sustain heavy weights. We thought, however, it would surely sustain the two boys. After they had all retired and it was too late to interfere, from sundry movements and murmurings overhead, it became evident that a readjustment had taken place and that Dr. Wiley and his huskiest son were in the weak bed while Nan and the younger boy occupied the bed for elephants. We listened in dreadful suspense for a breakdown. Fortunately none came and the extra weight was safely carried.

For ten days we heard nothing of the Wileys and then they drove up on their way home. They had had a wonderful time at Harvard and on the way home. On the way they stopped at a country hotel and John had climbed up to the peak of the roof and was unable to get down. Then he called to his father for help and that hard-hearted parent refused to assist him for some time but finally relented.

Mrs. Hart had no help in the kitchen and the Doctor thought they had better not stop but I persuaded him otherwise. I said: "We want you to stay. We will let you help us and will dispense with all frills. I have so arranged that Mrs. Hart shall not be overworked and shall be able to enjoy your visit." On that understanding they consented to stay. The next day was Thursday, the meeting day of our Rotary Club, and the Doctor, the Wiley boys and my own four boys were my guests at the Rotary lunch. They made quite an array, and there was much quiet amusement as they filed in and sat down. After the lunch Dr. Wiley was called upon to speak and made us a short address—such a happy talk as only Wiley can make.

In the meantime Mrs. Wiley and Dr. Kate De Witt Miesse, our family physician and a friend of Mrs. Wiley, and my wife, were dining at the Pomfret Club, guests of my wife. Behind the curtains that night I heard the story from my wife of how her two guests discoursed on woman's rights while she sat and listened and enjoyed the fun.

That night at dinner we had ice cream and cake for dessert, and the boys brought in the towering piece of cream fresh from the can. It towered above my wife as she sliced off the portions and finally toppled over on the platter.

Mrs. Wiley had been watching it in nervous terror, and as it went over she screamed and shouted: "My soul and body!" much to our amusement. The Doctor informed us that for a moderate surprise she called: "My soul!" but great occasions called for: "My soul and body!"

The next day was raining and we were not able to visit the farm as we had planned but spent the day at home resting. The following day was beautiful and we had an early breakfast that they might be soon on the road. The topic somehow shifted to the question of woman's rights and the Doctor proceeded to tell us how, in pursuit of these rights, his wife had become a criminal and been hustled to the gaol while her devoted family were scouring the country to find her.

They had been persecuting Mr. Wilson, he said, and merited their sad fate but he thought she had no business to leave three hopeless orphans stranded as she had. We all laughed and almost screamed with delight as the story proceeded.

After breakfast the Doctor begged us to go part way with them. They expected to stop at Valley Forge and they wanted us to go too. We finally agreed to go. At Doylestown my auto shed a tire and we sent for the garage man while we lunched in the shade of the trees. It was determined to leave my machine while I was to ride with my wife or with the Wileys. Then Mrs. Wiley cornered me and said I must not strike or push a lady while the Doctor paid the garage man.

When I tried to get in my wife's car I found all the boys there; of course they wanted to be together, so I got in with the Wileys. We drove around Valley Forge Park and enjoyed the beauty of the spot and reminded ourselves of the poor soldiers, freezing and starving the winter away, and proceeded to climb the tower. John went ahead and reached the very top before his mother spied him and then she once more screamed: "My soul and body!"

My boys were very fond of Mrs. Wiley. So was I until I became aware of the disaffection she had stirred up. Previous to this visit my wife had been obedient, as all wives should be, but now she began to speak up. She told us Mrs. Wiley said that every wife who took care of her man and his children was self supporting and had a *right* to share his wealth if he had any. This is

dreadful doctrine as all but the depraved must agree. I am wondering whether we had better have Mrs. Wiley again?

In the Days of the Roses

In the days of good King Harry the Sixth there was bitter strife in all the land between the houses of York and Lancaster. The adherents of one house oppressed, robbed and even murdered the adherents of the other. Political hatred grew apace and filled the land with civil wars. Houses were burned, churches were robbed and cattle were lifted. No one was sure of his life or property. Landless men were organized as bands of robbers making the highways unsafe. As a direct consequence of this waste of life and treasure the French lands won by Edward the Third, his son, the Black Prince, and Harry the Fifth were rapidly lost by the incapable Duke of Suffolk until only Calais and a strip of territory in the south of France remained.

With all his goodness the sixth Henry was but a feeble king, not ruling but ruled by his imperious wife and rugged, warlike barons. These were the days in which printing was invented, when armor was becoming useless before the advance of gunpowder and the introduction of firearms. The feudal system had entered upon its decay; superstition reigned but Lollardism under Wyckliffe had begun to undermine Roman Catholicism. The results of that terrible scourge, The Black Death, which swept Europe in 1347 carrying off a third of the population, were still felt in the scarcity of labor and higher wages.

Twenty miles northwest of London in the little town of St. Albans a fire broke out one day in June, 1440, in an old house in Dagnal Lane. It was a poor quarter and there was a loud outcry as the inhabitants began carrying their scanty belongings to safer places. The watch came clattering down the

street with their leather fire buckets and formed a line to the nearest well which was soon bailed dry. No attempt was made to save the burning house; efforts were confined to keeping the fire from spreading. Suddenly a woman screamed: "there are children in the house!"

"Body o' me," said Jed Fenchurch to his wife, "gie me thy apron!" Wrapping it around his face he dashed through the half open door, out of which smoke was pouring and presently emerged, choking, panting and cursing with a child on each arm, both unconscious.

"Thou art surely a brave one," said his wife, Lisbeth, proudly.

"Pook, woman!" said Jed, "should I let un die? Body o' me!"

But she was busy with the children, washing their faces with her apron and giving them water to drink. Presently the children struggled back to consciousness and began to cry, first the boy, then the girl. He might be three years old, but the girl was only a baby.

"I want mine nurth," sobbed the boy.

"He hath no hurt," said Lisbeth, "but, oh Jed, thy poor hands!"

They were, indeed, badly scorched and painful. His hair was singed, his eyebrows gone and his ears blistered but no serious harm had been suffered. When Lisbeth had attended to his burns she picked up the children and carried them to her house hard by.

On the morrow, when the ashes were raked the bones of a woman were discovered. The landlord of the Checquers said he had let the house but the day before to one Mary Smith who had paid a month's rent in advance. He knew nothing of her nor whence she came. Jed and Lisbeth kept the children; they were childless and well to do. There was no formal adoption. The children were supposed to be brother and sister. He said his name was Don, which was interpreted as John, and that her name was Banch, which was interpreted as Blanche.

Jed Fenchurch was an armorer, which a writer of that day has called the least mean of mean occupations. His shop at the back of the house, in a building entered by a passage way alongside. Here the children delighted to play and John helped as he was able as he grew stronger. Both attended the

Abbey school and were well educated for those days, when the scholar was a man who could read and write.

John naturally heard much about feats of arms and was taught at first hand the uses of arms and armor. He learned to use the long bow, and as he developed into young manhood, and his arm grew long and his muscles tough and strong, he drew his arrows to the nock. This weapon was then the arm of most reliance and its development, together with the use of dismounted cavalry, developed by Edward III and the Black Prince, the cause of the English strength.

Neither was Blanche neglected. Her foster mother, Lisbeth, had also been foster mother to the great Earl of Warwick and had learned much of gentle ways in the great castle. Many of these she imparted to Blanche, and was much blamed by her gossips for raising the child in ways above her station.

There came a day when the great Earl visited his foster mother. His visit was marked by festivities given by the holy fathers of the Abbey in his honor, where barrels of beer were broached and beeves were roasted whole. The Earl was a tall, well-built man of handsome presence and kindly mien, much beloved by gentle and common. He first greeted and kissed his old nurse; the children were then presented. John's height and reach of arm earned his commendation. "I will even take him into my service, an you wish," said he.

"Right gladly will he come, your highness," said Lisbeth, "you are good to your old nurse and her ward; God will reward you."

"Not so," said the Earl, "I but find a fine bowman."

"'Tis a fine deed, natheless, John," said Lisbeth when the Earl had departed, "and but shows the kind heart; but thou art the lucky boy! In all England lives no greater; and he will watch and guard thee; thou art indeed fortunate. Do I not know and love him?"

"Surely," said John, "I must do my best, more I cannot. Truly, thou art good to me."

"Alas, and shall I see thee no more? Wilt thou indeed leave us?" said Blanche, tears filling her eyes.

“Not so, sweetheart,” John replied, “when I go I shall soon return. How could I forsake thee, silly?”

The summons to arms was not long delayed. One evening in early May an express arrived at the Checquers and enquired for Jed Fenchurch. He was directed to the house on Dagnal Lane and informed Jed that he came from Warwick with directions to the bowmen, spearmen and men at arms to assemble at Royston and there await the arrival of the Duke of York and his own men.

There were but few Yorkists in St. Albans, but a party of bowmen, including Jed, John and three others were on their way afoot early the next morning, while the messenger continued his journey towards London.

“’Tis thretty good mile,” said fat Steve Balderstone in a thin voice, “I mind me when I walked as much in a day with good King Harry the Fift, but I were young then and light of foot. Truly the Duke moveth but slowly and we needs must wait at Royston. Why then shall we go apace?”

“Pook, thou elephant! the duke moveth at the gallop and the Earl also. Tarry not or ye may rue it,” said Jed. “Listen not to this squeaker. Body o’ me! we mun go apace.”

“I will blow thee to York with one puff, thou pot mender,” squeaked Steve.

“Truly, thou art a fine blower,” said Jed.

“Tarry a bit!” said John to Jabez Stout in a whisper, “see but the birds.”

And, in truth, over a wood to the right the birds were wheeling as the boys fell back and fitted an arrow to the string. From the wood three men on horseback drove rapidly into the road and galloped toward them.

“They are robbers,” said John, “take thou the one on the left” and their bows twanged and the arrows whistled.

The horseman on the right was transfixed by John’s shaft which pierced his right shoulder, and he fell from his horse which turned and fled. Jabez was not so fortunate; his shaft flew not so truly, but it caught the skin of the left leg of the rider and imbedded itself in the horse beneath which screamed and lashed out in agony, throwing the rider. The third horseman turned and galloped away. The rider of the stricken horse crawled into the bushes from

which he was quickly hauled and despatched, after which the men gathered around the man desperately wounded.

“Mercy! mercy! Sir John,” shrieked the stricken man looking at John, “Spare me! spare me! I am not fit to die!”

“Thou wilt die, sure enough,” said Steve, “thy right lung is shot through, but why call him Sir John? ’Tis but John Fenchurch.”

“’Tis the ghost of Sir John Jernyngan whom I stabbed at Bordeaux. Mercy! mercy!”

“He raves,” said Steve, “get along, John, out of his sight.”

“Leave him with me,” said Jed. “I would speak with him further.”

“’Tis as he told thee,” said Jed to the dying man when they were alone. “It was John Fenchurch.”

“I tell thee no!” he replied. “’Twas Sir John Jernyngan or his ghost. Thinkest thou I know not mine old enemy who stole my honors and my bride? Did I not see the old Duke of Warwick knight him at Savignies?” This was followed by a gush of blood as his spirit fled. Jed dragged the body to the roadside, rifled the pockets and followed the others, deep in thought.

II. IN THE FOREST

They camped with others at Royston until the arrival of the three Richards: Richard of York, Richard of Warwick and Richard of Salisbury, on May 20. Two days later found the Yorkists encamped outside St. Albans, with the Lancastrians in the town. After much parleying the Yorkists advanced to the attack. The Duke of York led on one wing, the Earl of Salisbury on the other, while John was with the Earl of Warwick in the center. The palisades at this point were old and rotten and the ditch dry. They were soon passed and the defenders driven back or killed.

“Come with me, Jabez,” said John as they advanced, “I know a way.”

“Surely, at the side of the house next the Checquers, the side door at the stairway where we met Rhoda,” said Jabez.

“Aye,” said John, “but go quietly along by the bushes that we be not seen.”

But they were seen, and an arrow found lodging in Jabez’ breast, who fell, while John reached and passed behind a projecting buttress that hid a small doorway. This opened on a stair, up which he passed to a window fronting on Checquers Street where he posted himself and began shooting at the Lancastrians in the street below. He had been closely followed by numerous archers and several men at arms. The archers posted themselves at the other windows while the men at arms broke into the rooms below, killed those posted there and issued forth into the street from the doorway. Presently Richard of Warwick issued forth into the street and led the fighting while other Yorkist archers broke into the houses on the other side of the street and shot from the windows, all the while shouting: “A Warwick! a Warwick!” Here you saw one fall with his brains dashed out, there another with a broken arm, a third with a cut throat and a fourth with a pierced chest, and the whole street was full of dead corpses.^[1]

As the Lancastrians broke and fled in confusion, John remembered Lisbeth and Blanche, unprotected. There was his place of duty. Straightway he descended and pushed his way along the crowded road to the house in Dagnal Lane in time to head the rabble who, crazed with blood and drink, had begun to sack the town.

“Come with me!” he called to the frightened pair, bursting in at the door, “but bring warm clothing; we must even sleep afield this night.” So saying he hurriedly filled a basket, caught up some wraps and started northward toward an angle of the palisade and ditch.

The flight of the vanquished was in three directions: Northwest toward Dunstable, along Watling Street, North toward Harpenden and southwest toward Watford.

Breaking down some palisades, John helped the women over the ditch and the three ran toward the shelter of the forest. This gained, he helped them climb into the arms of an ancient beech, where they lay concealed while the pursued and pursuers thundered by down the road on either side, and a scattering few stole through the underbrush below and around them.

As the night fell it grew colder, and Blanche crept into his arms, laid her head confidently against his shoulder and slept. The sleep of all three was, however, somewhat broken by the noises made by the peasantry searching with torches for the bodies of the slain.

In the morning, all danger having passed, John helped the women down and the three returned to their home which was in great disorder and bare of everything of value. It was a sad homecoming for the women, but it was useless to repine, so they set to work to clean the house and put it in order. John was informed that the Earl of Warwick desired his immediate attendance. “Is it true,” the Earl demanded, “that you led the archers up the stairway?”

“Yes, your Lordship,” said John, “I knew of the door and the stairway of old.”

“It was a great deed and shall not be forgotten, choose thy reward!”

“To serve your Lordship,” said John.

“Well said,” returned the Earl, “thou shalt be my page.”

“An your Lordship please, I would first bury Jabez Short who was killed beside me.”

“So do,” replied the Earl, “I will send for thee anon.”

John encountered Jed on his return; “do thou look after the women folk,” said Jed, “I must straight to London with the Earl.”

That morning the Duke of Norfolk marched into St. Albans with 6,000 men and the army started for London with the wounded King, who had been struck on the neck with an arrow.

Several days passed by before Jed could reach the Earl who was much engaged. In the meantime he was able to reach the Countess, Anne Beauchamp, who was the daughter of Richard Beauchamp, the former Duke, and sister of Henry, Duke of Warwick, from whom she had inherited.

The Countess informed Jed that she remembered Sir John Jernyngan, who was still living and well. He was a fine, upstanding man, tall, straight, with dark, somewhat curly hair and blue eyes. She remembered well how her father, who was the very flower of chivalry, and a gallant soldier, had knighted him for his gallant deeds on the field at Savignies. Lady Jernyngan was the daughter of Sir Everard Herbert of Bromhill in Hereford. Her hand had also been sought by one Victor Bozen, a soldier of fortune whose description was identical with that of the dead robber. It was true that he had the assurance to demand her hand in marriage, but the lady had openly scorned him, and in revenge he had stabbed her successful suitor who had never harmed him. She rejoiced that his son—for she doubted not John was his son—had unknowingly revenged the foul deed.

Romance, then as now, greatly appeals to the gentle mind. Anne became greatly interested in John and took him under her special protection. She became his advocate with the Earl, where he needed no advocate, and shielded him from the jibes and petty tyrannies of the pages at Warwick—her own castle—where he spent eighteen months perfecting himself in arms and chivalry.

On his first visit home after a six months' absence, Blanche flew at him, threw herself into his arms and kissed him.

“I have news for thee, sweetheart,” said John, “my Lady has discovered”—

“Well,” said Blanche, “what hath she discovered?”

“I had better not tell thee, ’twill make thee unhappy.”

“Nay, tell me!”

“Give me first six kisses!”

“There then, thou silly. Now tell me!”

“My, thy lips are sweet! She thinks thou art no sister of mine.”

“Oh John, how dreadful!”

“So I thought at first, but not now. We may wed.”

“Oh no! How could we?”

“We may and will. Now give me some more kisses.”

“Not so. If I am no sister why kiss? Too many have I given thee already.”

“My Lady says thou art Blanche Wychyngham, the daughter of Sir Edmund Wychyngham of Norfolk, and that we were stolen and carried off by my nurse who was a sister of that Victor Bozen I slew on the way to Royston. He had a grudge against thy father also.”

“Oh John! how dreadful. I cannot bear it.” And she ran off to her foster mother in tears.

III. THE WARRIOR AND LOVER

On the morrow came a letter bidding John join the Earl at Calais. Shortly thereafter Blanche left St. Albans to visit her father and sisters.

Among the Paston Letters is one from John Jernynge to his cousin, Margaret Paston, which is here reproduced with all the quaint spelling of those days:

Unto my ryght wurchipfell Cosyn, Marget Paston, this lettre be delyvered in haste.

Ryght wurchipful and my moste beste beloved maystres and cosyn, I recommaund me unto you as lowly as I may, evermor desyring to here of your gode welfar; the whiche I beseche Almyzthy Jesus to preserve you and kepe you to his plesur, and to your gracious herts desyre.

And yf it plese you to here of my welfar, I was in gode hele at the makynge of this lettre, blessed be God.

Praying you that it plese you for to send me word yf my fadyr wer at Norwiche with you at this Trenite Masse or no, and how the matyr doth betwene my Maystres Blawynche Wychynham and me, and yf ze suppose that it shall be brought a bowte or no; and how ze fele my fadyr, yf he be wele wylling thereto or no; praying you lowly that I may be recomaund lowly unto my maystres Arblastres wyfe, and unto my Maystres Blawynche, her dowzther, specially.

Ryght wurchipfull cosyn, yf it please you for to her of suche tydings as we have her, the basset [*embassay*] of Burgoyne schall come to Calleys the Saturday^[2] eftyr Corpus Christi day, as men say v. hondred horse of hem. Moreover on Trenite Sondag,^[3] in the mornynge, came tydings unto my Lord of Warwyke that ther were xxviij^{te} sayle of Spanyards on the se, and wherof ther was xvj. grete schippis of forecastell; and then my Lord went and manned fyve schippis of forecastell, and iii. carvells, and iiij. spynnes [*pinnaces*], and on the Monday,^[4] on the mornynge eftyr Trenite

Sonday, we met to gedyr afore Caleis, at iiij. at the klokke in the mornynge, and fawz thet gedyr till x. at the klokke; and ther we toke vj. of her [*their*] schippis, and they slowe of oure men about iiij^{xx} [*four score*] and hurt a ij. hondred of us ryght sore; and ther wer slayne on theyr parte abowte xij^{xx} [*twelve score*], and hurt a v. hondred of them.

And haped me, at the fyrste abordynge of us, we toke a schippe of iij^c [300] ton, and I was lefte therin and xxiiij. men with me; and thei fawzthe so sor^[5] that our men wer fayne to leve hem,^[6] and then come they and aborded the schippe that I was in, and ther I was taken, and was a prisoner with them vj houris, and was delyvered agayne for theyr men that wer taken before. And as men sayne, ther was not so gret a batayle upon the se this xl. wyntyr. And for sothe, we wer wele and trewly bette; and my Lord hathe sent for mor scheppis, and lyke to fyzthe to gedyr agayne in haste.

Nomor I write unto you at this time, but that it please you for to recomaund me unto my ryght reverent and wurchipfull cosyn your husband, and myn ownkll Gournay, and to myn awnte his wyfe, and to alle gode maysters and frends where it schall plese yow; and eftyr the writyng I have from you, I schall be at you in alle haste.

Wretyn on Corpus Christi day in gret haste, be your owne umble servant and cosyn,

JOHN JERNYNGAN.

The engagement with the Spaniards related in this letter was looked upon as a victory by the English. The next year there was another naval battle in which after a running two days' chase three out of five Genoese and Spanish ships were captured and brought into Calais, and Warwick became a naval hero to his countrymen.

On June 24, 1460, with Salisbury and March, Warwick landed at Sandwich, which Fauconberg had previously captured and held for the Duke of York. John Jernyngan, as we must now call him, was of course of the party. On July 2 they were in London, and on the 10th their army faced the army of the Red Rose in the meadows near Northampton.

The King's position was well protected by the crude artillery of that day, but there was a heavy rain storm and the pieces could not be discharged. The Lord Grey of Ruthven turned traitor to the King and assisted the advance of the young Earl of March who soon opened the way for the Yorkists. Buckingham, Shrewsbury, Beaumont, Egremont and Sir William Lucy with three hundred other Lords, knights and squires were killed and Henry was captured and taken to London.

In 1461, John was present at the rout of the Yorkists at the second battle of St. Albans and escaped with difficulty. In March of the same year he also took part in the decisive battle of Towton where the hopes of Henry the sixth and his Queen found their grave. This was a fiercely fought field where the mallets of lead crushed many a skull. In the nick of time the troops of the Duke of Norfolk arrived and the Lancastrians broke and fled. John had been in the front of the fighting, towering above the heads of the other knights and esquires with the exception of the new King Edward IV who was a mighty man and handsome. The slaughter was terrible. "No Quarter!" was the order, and most of those captured were promptly beheaded.

After the pursuit was at an end John returned to Saxton where he found the King who said:

"Thou art a valiant soldier. Kneel!"

Then he smote John gently on the back with his sword and said:

"Rise, Sir John Jernyngan! The field is won. Go now to thy people in Norfolk."

It may be imagined that this command of the King was promptly obeyed. When John arrived he discovered that the news of his new honor had preceded him. There were great rejoicings in which Blanche participated. To her he seemed a different man—older, more sedate, of greater knowledge, more to be admired and respected. She began to wonder what were his thoughts? and above all what he thought of her, but he gave at first no sign. In fact the slaughter after the battle had sobered him. It was borne in upon him that the King was cruel and that trouble must come. From boy he had become a man, accustomed to command and self-reliant. Like the moth near the flame Blanche was attracted and then repelled. She began to

dream, and he figured in her dreams. She was a beautiful girl, much courted and a trifle spoiled, but John seemed to her stronger, handsomer and better than her other men friends. He never wavered in kindness but said little. She became bolder and he met her advances. Soon she found herself hopelessly in love.

In those days love was not alone the concern of the lovers. Fathers and mothers, often overlords, and even sometimes the King, must be consulted. When all these tedious matters had been arranged there was a great wedding at Warwick Castle, where Anne insisted the ceremony must be performed. The Bishop of Canterbury said mass and married the couple in the presence of the King, the Earl of Warwick and many of the nobility.

After their marriage several years of peace followed. Then more strife and blood with the struggle between Edward and Warwick, the return of Henry for a brief period, the fight at Barnet and the death of Warwick, the accession of Richard III and his brief and bloody career ending in the fight and his death on Bosworth Field. With the accession of Henry VII, the wars of the roses were at an end; peace returned and our story ends.

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1. Whethamstede, quoted by M. E. Christie in "Henry VI."
 2. June 3rd.
 3. May 28th.
 4. May 29th.
 5. "For" in Fenn; seemingly a printer's error, as the word is "sore" in the modern version.
 6. Here, according to Fenn, the words "and go the" occur in the original, struck out.

The Red Devil

In the year 1903 I bought my first automobile. It was a Ford. Even as early as that the inimitable Henry was at work; but this car was quite unlike the modern Ford. It had double opposed cylinders placed horizontally on either side of the crankshaft which was in the middle and in the fore and aft axis of the machine. The engine was said to develop eight horsepower—perhaps it did. There was a front seat for two passengers and two corner seats for two more in the small tonneau back of it. The tonneau was entered by a narrow door in the middle of the back; below it was a step to enable the passengers to get up and down. There was no cover. The car was painted a brilliant red.

I was very much elated over my new car which had been carefully tested before I bought it. The salesman, who was also the mechanic, drove me over all the rough roads and steep hills in the vicinity. I drove it down one of these steep hills myself to test the brakes. Under all these tests the car behaved very well, but I soon found that a good-sized repair bill was a necessary part of the program. I also found myself gaining a profound respect for the mechanic, that is for some mechanics. I also discovered that it was necessary to spend three hours looking for the source of any trouble and but three minutes in fixing it.

There was a beautiful drive along the river. Every evening after my working day was over and I had had supper (we did not call it dinner) I was in the habit of driving several miles down the river and back before the night shut in. In case I lingered and the darkness overtook me there was a brilliant

headlight in the front of the car making the pathway as light as day. Usually some young lady of my acquaintance accompanied me on these drives. I was also fond of riding on Sunday afternoons. I asked Mrs. Henry to go with me one Sunday afternoon but she refused—she said it was wicked to take rides on Sunday.

“You might say that if I were driving a horse or an ass or anything that was my neighbor’s, Mrs. Henry,” said I, “but I am driving a soulless machine and it belongs to me.”

“Well, I don’t know very well just what the ins and outs are,” she replied, “but I don’t feel right when I go out driving on Sunday.”

Mr. Henry smiled—I knew he did not feel that much respect for Sunday—but when I asked him to go he declined; said he had a lot of writing to do, but I thought he was afraid.

I was determined to go and did not want to go alone. There was a baker’s daughter living on the same street. She was a very pretty girl, with a beautiful complexion and wonderful eyes. She had a smile and a kind word for everybody. When I asked her whether she would like to go she said: “yes she would, very much.” Now, that is what I like in a girl; I like a girl who knows her own mind.

Sally was a quiet girl, usually, but that afternoon she had a great deal to say. When she spoke she smiled at me, and she did not say a single unkind thing during the ride. I was very much pleased with Sally. I thought it would be nice to have her around all the time. I determined to take her again that evening; her mother told me, however, that she had gone to church with Jim Barkley. Jim was a bank cashier. He was getting a good salary and dressed very well. I looked at Mrs. Lunn with considerable interest. She was a very nice woman and her complexion was good, for she lived over a bakery, and spent much of her time in it. I had noticed that bakers and singers always had good complexions and were fat. Mrs. Lunn was fat, too—very fat. As I looked at her I said to myself: “that is how Sally will look in a few years,” and a chill stole over me.

I was living at a boarding house at this time. Several other members of the college faculty also boarded there. The food was pretty good but we were not very well satisfied. The dining table was rather small and was so full of

dishes that the coffee pot was placed on the floor alongside of the hostess. We had pie at every meal—a fresh pie at lunch and supper, and pieces of left-over pie for breakfast. Of course we need not eat pie, but so much pie was disconcerting. That coffee pot on the floor was disconcerting also. One of the boarders disturbed us, too. He was a minister and a very good young man, but when he wanted a piece of pie he looked straight at it, like a pointer dog, until some one asked him to have a piece. I had boarded for two years and I was growing tired of boarding. My position as a teacher in Rochambeau College was pleasant but I was growing restless.

The next Saturday I started to drive my car to Trenton. I was fond of reading, and it was my custom to visit Traver's bookstore in Trenton or Leary's in Philadelphia and purchase several books at a time. These second hand books answered my purpose perfectly and were much cheaper than new books. Sometimes I also attended vendues in the country and bought books, but this was not usually very satisfactory.

I had driven about a mile down the river when I overtook two girls traveling afoot in the same direction. One of them was very pretty. I asked them to get in. They looked doubtfully at each other but finally accepted my invitation. The oldest one told me her name was Fanny Hilltop and the pretty girl was her younger sister, Mary. Mary was rather quiet but seemed very pleasant. She smiled very often and when she smiled she showed a very pretty set of very white teeth. I had always admired white teeth and pretty girls and Mary seemed very nice. We came to a cross road very soon and the girls said they must get down there, they lived about a mile up the side road. I told them I was out for a ride, which was true enough, and that I might as well take them home, but they warned me the road was rough and hilly.

I turned into the by-road and though it was rough and rocky got along very well for over half a mile; then we came to a short, very steep hill. The car snorted and puffed and finally stopped. I let it back down, put on full speed and went at it again. It stuck fast again. By this time the girls had grown nervous backing down the hill, so I pulled the car to one side of the road and we walked to their house up several hills and directly on top of a mountain overlooking two beautiful valleys, one on either side. Their house was a very pretty one painted white. I told Mary that they had a right to the name of Hilltop but she said I had misunderstood, it was Hillpot. "Oh," said

I, “that must be a mistake. I believe one of your ancestors was a poor speller and twisted the spelling.”

The girls invited me to come in and rest or at least to sit down on the porch awhile. I chose the latter. The mother came out after awhile and I was introduced. She was a pleasant-looking, motherly soul, quick-motivated and rather thin. Her face was seamed with fine wrinkles and her hands showed signs of hard usage. I liked her looks and I liked Mary, too. They invited me to stay to dinner and I accepted. Fanny went to help her mother with the dinner while Mary entertained me. The father and a half grown boy came in after awhile.

Old man Hillpot looked me over pretty sharply, and I thought I knew just what he was thinking, but I wasn't thinking that at all. The boy looked at Mary and then at me and then he grinned and Mary's eyes snapped. I knew what he thought and what she thought. The old lady had a pleasant smile on her face as if she never thought at all, but I knew that she was doing a heap more thinking than all the others put together; for she was figuring out what each one thought and then what she should do herself so that everything should come out all right. I was getting to like the old lady.

After dinner Mary and I went out on the porch. The old lady and Fanny washed the dishes. The old man and the boy went off to milk the cows but the boy winked at Mary before he started and her eyes snapped again. After we had talked awhile I excused myself to get a drink in the kitchen. The old lady was washing the dishes. She had a dish pan full of soapy water and a dish cloth. First she scraped all the dishes as clean as possible; then she put them in the soapy water and rubbed them with the cloth; then she put them into another pan full of very hot water, took them out and laid them on the table. I got a towel and wiped them for her. She said:

“This isn't the first time you wiped dishes.”

“How do you know?” I replied.

“Because you washed your hands first, and you don't touch the dishes with your hands.”

“Yes,” I said, “I used to help my mother.”

“Is your mother living?” she asked.

“No,” I answered, “she died two years ago.”

“Oh, you poor boy,” she said; and she looked at me very sorrowfully.

Mary had come into the kitchen by this time but I thought she seemed somewhat bored. Pretty soon the old man and the boy came back and we all went out on the porch and had a real folksy talk. The boy was very much interested in the college and asked me a great many questions about it. He said he thought of going to college if it didn't cost too much. I told him it would be all right to go to college but I hoped after he got out he would come back and help his father farm. He said he didn't know about that and grinned at the old man; but the old man seemed very quiet; he just sat and listened; sometimes I thought he seemed a little sad. He appeared to be very fond of Fanny; he often looked at her, and when he did a pleasant look came over his face.

The old lady asked me to come again, real cordially, and then we all shook hands and I started off.

It was beginning to get dark when I reached the car. I was just ready to turn the crank when I heard some one say: “Get up Billy.” I looked up and found a pretty girl in a falling top was trying to make her horse pass the machine. He was frightened and wouldn't go and the girl seemed to be frightened too.

It was the law in those days that when a person driving a horse met an auto and held up a hand, the auto driver must drive to the side of the road, stop his car and lead the horse past the machine. So I went to the horse's head and led him past the machine. When we had gone a short distance up the road I asked the girl whether she could drive him now? She said she was afraid of him, he might run away. She didn't like to drive anyhow but there was no one to drive her that afternoon so she had hitched up the horse herself. I told her I would drive her home if it was not too far. She said her house was only half a mile up the road, so I got in and took the reins. The horse was old and stiff, but as his nose was pointed toward home and oats he made steady progress and we soon arrived. I had introduced myself to the lady who informed me that her name was Horner, that she taught school in the neighborhood and boarded at the farm house to which we were going. I remarked that Horner was a rural name and smelled of the dairy at which she managed to crack a smile. We had come by a side road at the last, down into a valley, over a bridge and up the other side to the farm house.

The farmer came out and held the horse while I helped the lady out. By this time the mother and her two daughters, Sarah and Jane Oldit, had come out and been introduced. We sat on the porch for awhile and then I started for home once more murmuring: Hilltop, Hillpot, Horner, Oldit!

II

Rochambeau College was denominational and of the blue Presbyterian order, under the care of the Synod. This connection was, however, almost purely theoretical and we were very much left alone to our own devices so long as no attempt was made by the President or members of the Faculty to blow loud heretical trumpets. Most of the members of the Board of Trustees were good fellows, mildly interested in the church and very much interested in educating young men. This real interest was manifested in an unmistakeable manner by their steady contributions to the College finances which at this time were not in too flourishing a condition. Not a few of the Trustees were depriving themselves of luxuries and even necessities in order that the Faculty might have decent living conditions. Not all the members of the Faculty appreciated this, but I did. Most of the members of our Board were earnest men worthy of respect and I, for one, did thoroughly respect them. The President, Dr. Camden, was a genial old chap, prone to discover all sorts of excellencies in the members of his Faculty and active in proclaiming them to the Board and to the world. He used the same methods with the students and was able to rule without despotism.

Some of his methods were, however quite near the border line which divides the good from the bad, and aroused the condemnation of some more rigid members of the Faculty who were rich enough to be independent. In most cases his makeshift measures were made necessary by lack of funds, and were, therefore, forgivable.

On my return home I found a letter awaiting me, and next morning, after my first class had recited I went to see the President. He came peering into the room with a frown on his face. On recognizing me his face lighted up and he advanced with both hands open and a beaming face.

“My dear Brown! I am so glad to see you.”

“I came over, Doctor,” said I, “to see whether you would be so good as to advise me? I have just had an offer from Ashton University, and am undecided what I had better do. I like my work very much here but they have offered me more money.”

“It is very good of you, Brown, to come to me at once and I appreciate it. I should be very sorry to have you leave, and if you will tell me whether a small addition to your salary will induce you to stay I will ask the Trustees to add, let us say, \$200.00 to your allowance. But now, my dear fellow I must ask you to do me a favor. You know that Professor Last is to leave us at the end of the year and I want you to teach Metallurgy. Only two lectures a week for one term, you know?”

“But, Doctor, I am not posted on Metallurgy.”

“Oh, but I feel sure you can do excellently well. It is very simple. You put the ore and fuel into a furnace, light the fire and there you are. And Brown! now we have settled that, I want you to take tea with me to-morrow evening. I must try to see more of you. I must see that you are taken care of.”

I laughed, thanked the Doctor, said I would come, and took my leave.

The next evening six people sat down at the President’s table: the Doctor and his wife, his niece, Kitty Camden and her brother Searles, Miss Hetty Poiret and myself. Kitty Camden was tall and stately while Hetty Poiret was quite small, with a rather shy manner and a sweet smile. Searles was younger than his sister, rather boyish in manner but a nice ingenuous lad. He was tall like his sister and nervous; his hands twitched, and he threw out his head from time to time as if his collar hurt him.

“There are several ages represented here,” said the Doctor, “I think I must tell my frog story.”

“Oh, no, Henry!” said his wife.

“Do, Doctor!” I broke in, “I have never heard it, and I like your stories.”

“There, Helen,” said the Doctor, “you see one person likes my stories.”

“We all like them, Doctor,” said Hetty Poiret.

“Well,” he began, “there is a place down below Philadelphia where the Schuylkill empties into the Delaware. The shores are low, flat and marshy. Tall grass grows down to the river’s edge; and here the tiny little frogs gather in the shallows as evening falls and peep shrilly: Schuyl—kill! Schuyl—kill! Schuyl—kill!

“Further up the river a creek flows in. There are trees along the bank. There is a very narrow beach with the banks rising abruptly and prevented from falling in by the tree roots. Here the middle-sized frogs gather in the evenings and call in middle-sized voices: Wis—sa—he—con! Wis—sa—he—con! Wis—sa—he—con!

“Further up, the stream is deeper. There are high banks which shelve off rapidly into deeper water. Along the edges solemn shadows form as the sun sets, and here the big bullies gather and croak in solemn tones: Man—yunk! Man—yunk! Man—yunk!”

“I like that story,” said Helen, “it is cute.”

“Yes, I like it, Doctor, that’s a good one,” I said.

“You never told me that one before,” said Kitty Camden, reproachfully.

The Doctor laughed. Then he began telling us about his travels. His wife had accompanied him, and occasionally she broke into the narrative to remind him of something he had forgotten. I have forgotten most of what he told us but I remember one part clearly. He said they had traveled over the Splugen on the Via Mala in a one-horse victoria driven by a black-browed, surly Italian. Coming down the southern slopes they passed through great groves of giant chestnuts. Nothing else would grow there, for immense rocks covered the surface and made cultivation impossible. These trees bore crops of the large Italian chestnuts with which we are familiar from seeing them on our fruit stands. These are gathered by the peasants and stored in bags in the lofts overhead until they are well dried. They are then taken down and beaten with sticks. This breaks the hulls which are winnowed out. The meat is then beaten to flour in mortars and *polenta* or mush made of it which forms almost the only food of the peasants.

III

As Trenton had not been reached the preceding Saturday, I determined to try again and to take Sally with me. Sally said she would be delighted to go. Next morning at about eight we were ready for the trip. It was a beautiful morning and Sally was as sparkingly pretty as a morning daisy. It was a pleasure to look at her. She had a parcel done up in paper which I stored in the tonneau. When I turned the crank nothing happened. I turned the crank again—still nothing happened. At the third turn there were two explosions and then silence. Fourth turn, ditto. Fifth turn, the engine ran for some time and just as we were ready to move stopped again. By this time my patience had a very thin edge, but, fortunately, the next turn gave the desired result and we were off.

My car had a serious defect: the radiator was too small and the water grew hot and boiled about every three miles. If there was much climbing the distance traveled before this happened was less. In consequence it was necessary to let the boiling water escape and provide a fresh charge, which required frequent running to the pump with a collapsible bucket.

About three miles from our starting place we reached a roadside spring and I replaced the water and plied the oil can. Not many yards below the spring we overtook a young lady walking in the direction we were going. It was Miss Horner on her way to the village just below. We stopped and asked her to ride with us. She was on her way to her school for some books which had been forgotten. On reaching the school we were invited to inspect it. It was an old-fashioned place, painted yellow outside, with a large coal stove at one side and blackboards surrounding the room on all the available wall space. There was a bench before the teacher's desk on which the lazy or naughty pupils stood during the noon or recess periods.

After we left her Sally was very inquisitive. She wanted to know who she was, where she came from, how and where I had met her. Satisfied on these points we proceeded happily on our way. Presently the car began to steam and I to look for a watering place. The canal was close to the road, and after considerable searching I found a place where it was possible to reach the water with my bucket. I succeeded in doing so after some stretching but in

lifting the bucket the weight of the water overbalanced me and down into the water I slid.

Sally cried out in alarm but wasted no time in thrusting a stick from the roadside into my hands. Then I was slowly and carefully pulled in and helped up the bank. I was in a pretty pickle. Wet from head to foot; my collar and shirt in collapse; my shoes filled with water, and my hat gone. I told Sally it did not matter. It was warm and I would soon dry off. As for my hat and collar I could replace them at the next country store. She said I was very brave and she was proud of me; and as she said this her eyes sparkled and her cheeks were full of rosy color. I had been very much surprised at her prompt, vigorous action in helping me and also at the strength she displayed. With her permission I removed my coat and shoes and laid them to dry in the tonneau. Then with a considerable increase in cordiality we once more took the road. At frequent intervals we were obliged to water the car and might fairly be said to have worked our passage. At Lehighburg or Monroe we entered the red shale country which extends to Trenton and below. In many places this shale is covered with river sand or is replaced by sandstone rock belonging to the same formation but less strongly colored with iron oxide. Over roads varying in character but mostly bad we proceeded. From Erwinna to Point Pleasant the road was especially bad, being both rocky and muddy. By careful driving I managed to avoid splashing the car very badly. At New Hope we crossed the river and proceeded toward Trenton. It was now time for lunch and we drew up by the roadside under a maple and Sally produced her package which contained a lunch fit for kings. This we discussed amid a cheerful rain of jokes and chaff.

After lunch we proceeded and soon entered State Street and turned down South Broad. There were few cars in those days and no traffic policemen so that we could turn the car on South Broad and draw up before the bookstore.

I was a great admirer of Stockton and Stevenson and so I found was Sally. In the stock of second hand books by these authors we found copies of "The Lady and the Tiger," "The Casting Away of Mrs. Lecks and Mrs. Aleshine," "The Christmas Wreck" and "Amos Kilbright" by Stockton and "The Black Arrow," "Kidnapped" and "The Strange Case of Mr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde" by Stephenson. These we considered a great find and the price was very

reasonable. They were stowed in the tonneau and Sally took her seat while I turned the crank. This time we started off without trouble.

We had got as far as Lambertville on the return when trouble with the car began to develop. The engine would run properly for awhile and then it would slow down and almost stop, then it would start running properly again. This continued until we were several miles above New Hope. Here the engine gave out completely. After trying in vain to start it again I abandoned hope and Sally and I pushed the car to the roadside and started off for help. We walked nearly a mile before we came to a house. I knocked at the door which was opened by a nice-looking boy of about ten years. In answer to my enquiry he said his Pop was at the barn and if we would sit down he would go after him. Presently the boy's mother came in and we told her the car had broken down. She thought we had better spend the night there and go on in the morning. She had a spare room which we might use. I thought further explanations were in order and the old lady said if I would be content with a cot the young lady might have the spare room and I could sleep in the attic. I thanked her and, after consulting Sally, accepted. When the farmer came in we found nothing else could be done. He promised to drive me to New Hope in the morning and get a mechanic. I lay awake for a long time wondering what could be the matter. Finally it occurred to me that the gasoline might have given out. The next morning we had an early breakfast and the farmer and I drove to the car. Sure enough we found the tank as dry as a bone. Then we went on to New Hope and after some searching found gasoline and partly filled the tank. After turning the engine over several times it caught and we drove up to the house. Sally seemed to be worried but she said very little. On the way home she said she was afraid her mother might worry and wished there were some way to get word to her. I suggested that we telegraph but we found all the offices closed.

About 11 o'clock we reached home. I went in with Sally. Her mother seemed worried. She said she had been very much distressed by our non-arrival the night before and looked at me searchingly. I told her I had been very stupid but she must remember I had run a car only a short time and was not very experienced. Sally said she was sure I was not to blame.

The next day I needed some money and went to the bank. Jim Barkley waited on me and after he had cashed the check said:

“I hear you were stalled the other day because you had no gasoline? Pretty slick excuse.”

“No,” I said, “do you think so?”

“Ho, ho,” he said, “ho, ho!”

“He, he,” I said, “he, he!”

He looked pretty black at this but said nothing more.

I went to call on Sally that evening and she greeted me with smiles. She wanted to know whether I had caught cold? I said no, I had not. She told me she thought Jim Barkley was very disagreeable. He had been making nasty remarks about me. He had told Hetty Poiret that I was a prig. She thought he was very ugly-tempered and very stupid. Before I left she asked me whether I often took cold. I said I did. She advised me if I felt I was taking cold to soak my feet in hot water in a wooden bucket, the water should be very hot and contain a teaspoonful of soda. Then I must wipe my feet with a dry, hot towel and get into bed. She did not say retire, she said get into bed. I had not had such advice since my mother died two years before. She looked very earnest and very much concerned as she said it. It was not a romantic speech but somehow I liked to have her say it.

IV

The following Saturday I planned to take a trip to Doylestown. I had some relatives there whom I had not seen for some time and Fanny and Mary Hillpot had agreed to go with me. Their cousin lived there. I was doubtful about my ability to drive my car to the Hillpot house and experiment proved my doubt to be well founded. By making a strong spurt I succeeded in getting up the first hill but stuck fast on the second. I climbed the rest of the hill afoot. Mary was as pretty as a picture and I admired her very much. She certainly had beautiful teeth and was all smiles when I arrived. The girls were soon ready and we walked to the car and started. Mary was beside me and Fanny in the tonneau with some wraps, two umbrellas and some lunch. We were nearing Kintnersville when dark clouds began to pile up on the horizon and presently it began to rain. The girls were in the tonneau each with an umbrella and I was on the front seat with a rubber coat and hat. The rain came down in bucketfuls and then began to blow. The water collected in a pool on the front seat and ran down my leg into my shoe. The girls' feet and skirts got wet and Mary began to cry. Fanny was just as wet but she laughed and seemed to be enjoying herself. I drove as rapidly as possible and got under a shed at Ferndale. Mary was as cross as a wet hen. Her hair had lost its curl, her hat was awry and she showed neither smile nor white teeth. The girls went into the hotel and after quite a long stay came out somewhat drier and ready to proceed. But Mary was sulky and disagreeable. After the shower passed over we started again, but now there was mud everywhere—thin splashy red mud that flew over everything. At Pipersville Hill it was necessary for the girls to walk up the hill and their feet were very muddy and wet. Between Pipersville and Plumstedville there was a swampy spot where the car stuck fast. Fanny helped me get stones to put under the wheels while Mary sat on the fence and glowered at us. Finally we got started again and reached Doylestown. Here we separated. While I was visiting my cousins a hostler washed the car and after it was ready I drove around, took the girls in and started for home. We got back without accident and then I visited the Oldit place. Sarah and Jane were at home but Miss Horner had not arrived. We sat on the front porch and the girls raked over the characters of all the neighbors. I found they had had a

disagreement also with Miss Horner. There were several vicious digs given after she arrived and I departed somewhat depressed.

The next evening I took Sally to Dr. Camden's to call on the young visitors. We found Jim Barkley there. He paid marked attention to Hetty Poiret all the evening. Occasionally he glanced at Sally or me but we avoided him as much as possible. We did not have a very pleasant evening. Searles and Kitty had been quarreling and were still skirmishing. We left early and walked home in the moonlight.

The next morning people who met me looked unusually pleasant and seemed amused. I could not understand it until I reached Sally's house again. She met me at the door and called to her mother as I came in:

"Here he is mother! Now we shall see!"

"Did you know," she said turning to me, "that Jim Barkley says that you were in Doylestown yesterday driving two girls in a red devil as drunk as a lord?"

"No," I replied, "I did not. I was in Doylestown driving my red car and Fanny and Mary Hillpot were with me but I was not drunk. I had had nothing at all to drink."

"There, Mother," said Sally, "I told you he did not drink."

"And did you know," she continued, "that he says we stayed at a farm house together on Saturday night, and then he winks."

"The dirty dog," I said, "I think I can stop his mouth."

Sally and her mother were both in tears but I comforted them by telling them that I would bring the farmer and his wife up next day. I did so and drove around to Dr. Camden's house. I told the Doctor my story and asked him to question the farmer and his wife. He agreed to this and did so. Then I drove them to the bank and asked Mr. Davis, the President of the bank to listen to them in Jim Barkley's presence. Jim declared that he had been misquoted but I brought Hetty Poiret to the bank to contradict him. Then I took the farmer and his wife back home after warmly thanking them.

That evening I went again to see Sally. She blushed beautifully as she opened the door. "Sally!" I said, "I came here to tell you that you are the

dearest, sweetest, prettiest, smartest, nicest girl in the world, and that I love you, love you, love you.”

“Oh, do you?” said Sally, “I am so glad.”

“Did you ever hear of the young man whose ecstasy was so great under similar conditions that he broke the poor girl’s ribs?” I did not break Sally’s ribs but I held her tight and she laughed and her eyes sparkled and then she cried a little. Presently she said she must tell her father and mother. They all came in presently and shook hands with me and her mother kissed me. “If Sally loves you I must too,” she said, and then she wiped her eyes. They both looked sad. “You know, she is our baby,” her father said, “and it is pretty hard to lose her. Please be good to her.”

I said: “I don’t think I am much account, but Sally says she loves me and I’m sure I love her, and I will promise you to be good to her and try to be a better man every day.”

Well, we had a fashionable wedding in a month from that time. Jim Barkley was not present because he was looking for another job in New York. Sally and I have been married now for twenty years and have two fine boys in college. Sally is getting as round as a dumpling, but I like her so much I never notice what she looks like. Neither do the boys. So much kindness shines from her eyes when she looks at us that we see nothing else.

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Transcriber's Notes

Note: The transcriber has corrected what were deemed to be obvious printer's errors and normalized hyphenation where a predominant variant could be found. Archaic spellings have been retained. Changes to the text are listed below:

[Pg. iii](#): Added missing comma: 'Writer and Speaker Fearless Publicist' to 'Writer and Speaker, Fearless Publicist'

[Pg. 12](#): Missing close-quote inserted: 'for bread at the store.' to 'for bread at the store.'"

[Pg. 12](#): Missing close-quote inserted: "Hi! said Reddy' to "Hi!" said Reddy'

[Pg. 14](#): Corrected typo: 'loaves of bred' to 'loaves of bread'

[Pg. 16](#): Corrected typo: 'crows feet' to 'crow's feet'

[Pg. 17](#): Missing open-quote inserted: 'z-z-z.'" to "'z-z-z.'"

[Pg. 23](#): Corrected typo: 'there came a knockiing' to 'there came a knocking'

[Pg. 24](#): Missing open-quote inserted: 'said the archer, that must' to 'said the archer, "that must'

[Pg. 25](#): Missing open-quote inserted: 'she replied, and you will' to 'she replied, "and you will'

[Pg. 29](#): Missing open-quote inserted: ' said I, but trample' to ' said I, "but trample'

[Pg. 32](#): Corrected capitalization: 'ishmaelite' to 'Ishmaelite'

[Pg. 39](#): Normalized hyphenation. Predominantly spaced: ‘with some-one else’ to ‘with some one else’

[Pg. 41](#): Added missing period to contraction: ‘Castel de St Angelo’ to ‘Castel de St. Angelo’

[Pg. 42](#): Normalized hyphenation. Hyphenated elsewhere: ‘first hand information’ to ‘first-hand information’

[Pg. 46](#): Fixed word mix-up: ‘pointing to the guide’ to ‘pointing to the policeman’

[Pg. 49](#): Corrected typo: ‘Baptisery’ to ‘Baptistery’

[Pg. 61](#): Corrected typo: ‘the assembled anaeobists’ to ‘the assembled anaerobists’

[Pg. 65](#): Missing word added: ‘a blank stare a’ to ‘a blank stare and a’

[Pg. 76](#): Added missing punctuation: ‘part of the way the rest’ to ‘part of the way; the rest’

[Pg. 84](#): Corrected typo: ‘should weight at least’ to ‘should weigh at least’

[Pg. 94](#): Moved wrongly placed quote marks: “‘It is too bad said her mother,’” to “‘It is too bad,” said her mother,’

[Pg. 97](#): Added hyphen for consistency. Hyphenated elsewhere: ‘nice looking’ to ‘nice-looking’

[Pg. 97](#): Removed two extra periods: ‘with photo., Box. 28’ to ‘with photo, Box 28’

[Pg. 103](#): Added missing comma at quote close: ‘ you know” said Sam’ to ‘ you know,” said Sam’

[Pg. 107](#): Missing close-quote inserted at para end: ‘how to control it.’ to ‘how to control it.”’

[Pg. 110](#): Corrected typo: ‘a dark stirway’ to ‘a dark stairway’

[Pg. 118](#): Corrected typo: ‘millenium’ to ‘millennium’

[Pg. 123](#): Changed upper case to lower after comma: ‘Very well, You are’ to ‘Very well, you are’

[Pg. 138](#): Corrected spacing for consistency. Spaced out elsewhere: ‘Body o’me!’ to ‘Body o’ me!’

[Pg. 138](#): **Note:** Named Jabez Short later in the text

[Pg. 139](#): Corrected typo: ‘The horesman on the right’ to ‘The horseman on the right’

[Pg. 139](#): Added missing open-quote: ‘Thou wilt die’ to “‘Thou wilt die’

[Pg. 140](#): Removed extra close-quote: ‘or his ghost.” Thinkest thou’ to ‘or his ghost. Thinkest thou’

[Pg. 141](#): Changed upper to lower case after comma: ‘Whethamstede, Quoted by’ to ‘Whethamstede, quoted by’

[Pg. 147](#): Removed duplicate word: ‘and and myn ownkll’ to ‘and myn ownkll’

[Pg. 152](#): Added missing apostrophe: ‘that was my neighbors’ to ‘that was my neighbor’s’

[Pg. 154](#): Normalized hyphenation. Predominantly spaced: ‘until someone asked him’ to ‘until some one asked him’

[Pg. 154](#): Normalized spacing; unspaced elsewhere: ‘Traver’s book store’ to ‘Traver’s bookstore’

[Pg. 157](#): Missing close-quote inserted: “‘Yes, I said,’ to “‘Yes,” I said,’

[Pg. 161](#): Removed extra open-quote: “‘I laughed’ to ‘I laughed’

[Pg. 162](#): Removed extra close-quote: ‘said Hetty Poiret.’” to ‘said Hetty Poiret.’

[Pg. 163](#): Added missing comma at quote close: ‘like that story” said Helen’ to ‘like that story,” said Helen’

[Pg. 173](#): Added missing comma, open-quote and corrected typo: ‘she continued that he says we stayed at a farm house together on Saturady’ to ‘she continued, “that he says we stayed at a farm house together on Saturday’

[Pg. 173](#): Removed extra open-quote at para start: ““Sally and her mother’ to ‘Sally and her mother’

[Pg. 174](#): Missing close-quote inserted: ‘poor girl’s ribs?’ to ‘poor girl’s ribs?’”

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